

Permeable Patronage: Fiscal Crises and Domain-Specific Defection in the Greek Parliament, 1875–1905

Abstract

How do clientelist parliaments behave when fiscal crisis arrives? Existing work expects hard budget constraints to weaken patronage and push politics toward programmatic competition (Kitschelt 2000; Kitschelt and Wilkinson 2007; Stokes et al. 2013; Kitschelt and Wang 2012). This paper draws on 755 nominal roll calls and 132,246 MP-vote observations from the Hellenic Parliament, 1875–1905. The result is not a general move from patronage to programme, and not general fiscal leakage either. The argument is structural: patronage discipline holds by default and breaks selectively when legislation imposes unambiguous costs on specific constituencies — making visible the MP-level heterogeneity in constituency exposure that bloc discipline normally suppresses. After default, currant-targeting legislation reached the floor in March 1894 and again in July 1895; on both occasions, currant-coast Peloponnesian MPs broke discipline while interior Peloponnesians held. On a contested non-targeting currant-policy vote in February 1894, Coast and Interior split symmetrically, distinguishing genuine preference heterogeneity from patronage-enforced cohesion. The pattern is event-driven, not time-decaying: the 1895 recurrence comes sixteen months after default, with largely null fiscal months in between. The pre-period shows a long-run Peloponnese-vs-rest fiscal compliance gap that MP fixed effects absorb; the design identifies deviations from this structural pattern. The 1896 death of Trikoupis produced a parallel pattern on budget allocation through patron-removal coordination loss. After 1898, external fiscal control removed the legislative occasions on which the mechanism could surface. Clientelism survived because crisis exposed discipline only at event-driven flash points; durable change required institutional constraint from outside parliament.

1. Introduction

How do clientelist parliaments behave when fiscal crisis arrives? Greek MPs in the late nineteenth century worked in a parliament with weak party organisation, personal mandates, and chronic fiscal fragility. Leaders held factions together by distributing office, contracts, public works, and fiscal relief. When default, foreign-imposed austerity, and the loss of fiscal autonomy cut into those resources, the natural expectation — from a large comparative literature — is that the system should give way to something more programmatic. It did not. But it also did not break uniformly under fiscal stress. The pattern in the roll-call record is sharper and stranger than either reading allows for, and the puzzle this paper takes up is what kind of system produces that pattern.

Much of the clientelism literature expects hard budget constraints to strengthen programmatic politics. In the canonical account (Kitschelt 2000; Kitschelt and Wilkinson 2007; Stokes et al. 2013), clientelism persists where patronage resources are abundant and weakens when those resources contract. Kitschelt and Wang (2012) put the point directly: economic crises can create “windows of opportunity” to raise the programmatic content of party competition. Fiscal political economy models frame the same shock differently: in Alesina and Drazen’s (1991) war-of-attrition model, stabilisation is delayed because groups accept that adjustment is necessary but hold out to shift the burden onto others. Both literatures are usually evaluated with aggregate evidence — party systems, elections, surveys, macro-political outcomes — because individual voting records rarely survive in nineteenth-century parliaments. The Hellenic Parliament between 1875 and 1905 is one of the few settings where a panel of nominal roll calls long enough to span fiscal shocks does survive: 755 votes, 132,246 MP–vote observations, with biographical matching to parliamentary registries and coverage dense enough to classify votes by policy domain.

The argument this paper develops is structural rather than causal. Patronage discipline holds by default, across most legislative business and across most fiscal business. It does not erode smoothly as fiscal resources contract, and defection is not a transient response to fiscal stress that decays back to baseline as the shock ages. Defection is a signature of latent MP-level heterogeneity in constituency exposure — MPs differ in how directly their voters bear the costs of particular legislation — and bloc discipline normally keeps that heterogeneity invisible in roll-call behaviour. What makes it visible is the legislative agenda. When parliament takes up votes whose distributive consequences fall unambiguously on specific constituencies in ways that conflict with the bloc line, the underlying heterogeneity surfaces; otherwise it stays absorbed in the fixed effects of cohesive bloc voting. The 1893 sovereign default is therefore not the treatment whose effect this paper estimates. The default is the event that put currant-targeting fiscal legislation onto the parliamentary agenda; the agenda is what produces the votes on

which heterogeneity reveals itself. The paper's claim is about how clientelist parliaments respond to fiscal stress in general, with the late-nineteenth-century Greek episodes serving as the windows through which the structural pattern becomes visible.

The empirical evidence comes from two such windows. The first is the post-default period, where Coast-specific defection by Peloponnesian MPs concentrates in two clusters of currant-targeting legislation. On March 5, 1894, three consecutive tax-relief proposals for currant-producing provinces drew Coast defection at 13–26% across the cluster while interior Peloponnesian MPs held at 0% defection on all three roll calls. A precursor vote two days earlier on a Messinezis tax-relief proposal showed a weaker pattern (Coast 33%, Interior 17%); the asymmetric Coast-vs-Interior signature is sharpest on the March 5 cluster. Sixteen months later, on July 11–12, 1895, a cluster culminating in the third reading of the currant-taxation bill (φορολογίας του σταφιδοκάρπου) drew Coast defection at 19–47% with zero defectors among the 45 interior MPs voting. Between these two clusters, fiscal roll calls produced no comparable Coast-specific signal: the pattern is event-driven by the appearance of currant-targeting legislation on the floor, not time-decaying after the default.

A contested non-targeting currant-policy vote in the same period demonstrates the identification logic directly. On February 22, 1894, the Trikoupis παρακράτησις withholding bill — a currant-policy measure that did not impose location-specific costs on currant-producing provinces — split Coast and Interior symmetrically at roughly 37% defection on both sides. Genuine preference disagreement among currant-producing MPs about the policy mechanism produced bilateral defection that is not absorbed into bloc cohesion; constituency-targeting legislation produces asymmetric defection that is. Within a fortnight of each other, the chamber records the two patterns side by side, and the contrast between them is what distinguishes preference heterogeneity from patronage-enforced cohesion in the analysis that follows.

The second window is the death of Harilaos Trikoupis in March 1896. The post-1896 fiscal collapse was concentrated on budget-allocation votes rather than on tax votes, and was chamber-wide rather than Coast-specific. The mechanism is different — patron-removal coordination loss rather than constituency-targeting agenda content — and the domain is different. But the underlying phenomenon is the same: latent MP-level heterogeneity that bloc discipline normally suppresses, made visible when the conditions sustaining suppression change. The 1894–1895 currant clusters and the 1896 budget collapse are not two independent findings about two different shocks. They are two readings on the same structural feature of how this kind of parliament works.

A pre-period note. The event-study comparison shows a long-run Peloponnese-vs-rest fiscal compliance gap visible across 1885–1893 — Peloponnesian MPs were systematically more compliant on fiscal votes than the rest of the chamber throughout

the pre-shock decade, not only in the years immediately preceding default. The MP fixed effects absorb this gap in level; the design identifies deviations from the structural pattern, and §6.1 develops the implication for identification.

This pattern refines what the war-of-attrition account predicts in this setting. Alesina and Drazen's (1991) framework specifies that contested-cost groups defect when adjustment becomes unavoidable, and the Greek evidence is consistent with that prediction in direction. But the level at which the conflict resolves is not the aggregate fiscal stance and not the taxation domain as a whole. It is the specific contested bill: currant-targeting legislation when it reaches the floor, in the months when it does, and largely not otherwise. War-of-attrition predicts that adjustment will be delayed by group conflict; the structural claim sharpens this to which groups (currant-coast MPs whose constituencies bear the targeted cost, not Peloponnesians as a bloc), on which votes (legislation that targets those constituencies, not fiscal business broadly), and at what tempo (event-driven by agenda content, not smoothly time-decaying after the shock).

The paper makes three contributions. Empirically, it documents how patronage discipline breaks under fiscal stress at the roll-call level, with cluster-specific evidence on currant-targeting legislation in 1894 and 1895 and a complementary signature of the same phenomenon in the 1896 budget collapse. Non-economic crises in 1897 and 1901 produced no comparable signature, bracketing the structural claim's scope to fiscal-stress conditions where constituency-targeting legislation reaches the floor.

Methodologically, it uses within-Peloponnese coast-versus-interior contrasts and within-session domain contrasts — alongside the symmetric February 1894 vote as a within-region preference benchmark — to identify constituency-cost heterogeneity from observational roll-call data. Theoretically, it characterises patronage discipline as a default state that breaks selectively under specific legislative content, rather than as a property that erodes under generalised fiscal stress. For clientelism research, this displaces the smooth-decay reading of fiscal crisis. For models of delayed stabilisation in fiscal political economy (Alesina and Drazen 1991; Drazen and Grilli 1993), it supplies parliamentary micro-evidence that the war of attrition resolves at the level of specific contested bills rather than at the level of the overall fiscal stance. For legislative studies, it shows why observed voting cohesion must be separated from the mechanism that produces it, whether shared preferences, party organisation, or patronage enforcement.

The contrast with Blankart's (2011) Swiss fiscal-discipline equilibrium is instructive. In Switzerland, institutions reinforced restraint, and the equilibrium was sustained from inside the political system. In Greece, wide suffrage, weak bureaucracy, factional leadership, and discretionary access to state jobs and contracts reinforced patronage, and fiscal stress did not by itself produce programmatic parties, parliamentary whips, or a bureaucracy insulated from patronage. After 1898, the International Financial Commission removed currant taxation from the domain of parliamentary bargaining

altogether, and with it the legislative occasions on which the constituency-cost mechanism could surface. The mechanism shut off because the agenda no longer contained the votes that triggered it.

The dataset is built from OCR'd volumes of the parliamentary debates (Εφημερίδα των Συζητήσεων), using Greek-language OCR produced in Paris Aslanidis's Marie Curie project and an earlier English transcription as a cross-check. Votes are linked to MPs through a four-tier name-matching procedure and classified by policy domain. Gardikas (1988) previously analysed Greek parliamentary divisions for 1875–1885; this paper extends coverage to 1905 and adds full roll-call coverage, biographical matching, bloc assignment, and domain coding.

The paper is organised as follows. §2 sets out the historical background, including the structure of late-nineteenth-century Greek parliamentary politics and the role of the Peloponnese within it. §3 develops the theoretical framework. §4 describes the data and the construction of the panel. §5 reports descriptive evidence on factional cohesion and cross-topic voting. §6 sets out the empirical strategy and the identification logic. §7 reports the results, including the cluster-level evidence on currant-targeting legislation, the symmetric February 1894 vote, and the complementary 1896 finding. §8 discusses implications for the comparative study of clientelism and for fiscal political economy.

2. Historical Background

2.1 Greek Political System, 1875–1905

The Constitution of 1864 established a unicameral Vouli elected under universal male suffrage for all men aged twenty-one and above, with neither literacy nor property requirements. By contemporary European standards, the franchise was wide. Britain before the 1884 Reform Act enfranchised roughly three million of approximately twelve million adult men, and Italy retained literacy requirements until 1912, with an electorate on the order of two percent of the population before the 1882 reform. Greek election administration accommodated illiteracy. Voters cast lead balls into candidate-specific boxes. Clogg (2002) provides the standard English-language narrative of this period, situating the constitutional framework within the broader trajectory of Greek state formation from independence through the First World War. Koliopoulos and Veremis (2010) offer a complementary account, emphasising the interaction between domestic political development and the external constraints imposed by Great Power diplomacy and chronic fiscal dependence.

The *dedilomeni* principle was established by convention in 1875 after Trikoupis's “Τίς πταίει;” (“Who is to blame?”) article. It held that the King should appoint as prime minister the politician who commanded parliamentary confidence. The norm was not

written into the constitution. King George I retained discretion and used it, including dismissing Deligiannis in 1892 by royal prerogative without a parliamentary vote. By comparative standards, Greek executive instability was extreme: Warwick (1992) finds that the median parliamentary government in postwar democracies survives roughly two years, whereas Greek cabinets in this period averaged 12.1 months (median 7.5 months), a level of turnover that placed extraordinary demands on whatever coordination mechanisms substituted for stable party government.

The Crown's role complicates any purely parliamentary account of factional behaviour. The King could dismiss a prime minister without a no-confidence vote, appoint a caretaker, or call elections at his discretion. MPs therefore operated under dual monitoring: the factional patron controlled access to offices and contracts, but the King controlled access to government itself. In the 1885 episode, Trikoupis dissolved parliament after winning the recall confidence vote—but the dissolution required royal assent, and the King's willingness to grant it shaped the strategic calculus. For the empirical design, the Crown's role is a source of unobserved institutional variation that is constant across domains within a given episode. It does not confound the domain-specific comparisons (fiscal versus non-fiscal defection) that form the core identification, but it does mean that cross-episode comparisons of overall defection levels (β_1) should be interpreted cautiously, since some government transitions reflect royal initiative rather than parliamentary dynamics.

Greece's institutional trajectory placed it squarely in the category Shefter (1994) identifies as most prone to entrenched clientelism: democratisation preceded bureaucratisation. Universal male suffrage arrived in 1864, decades before any professional civil service was established. Politicians captured the state apparatus before it was insulated from partisan control, making patronage the default mode of political mobilisation. In Shefter's framework, this sequencing predicts that clientelism should resist fiscal pressure—because the state itself is the patronage instrument, and fiscal crisis does not change who controls the bureaucracy. The Greek evidence matches this prediction: the post-1893 fiscal pressure produced selective defection on the constituency-targeting bills it put onto the parliamentary agenda, not institutional reform of the state apparatus, and discipline held by default until external fiscal control in 1898 removed the triggering bills from the legislative agenda altogether.

Parliamentary competition operated through factions rather than formal parties (Legg 1969; Hering 1992). Legg's account emphasises that clientage relationships were reinforced by chronic insecurity and weak institutional trust, conditions that made patronage exchange the rational default for both patrons and clients even as the formal franchise expanded. MPs ran on personal lists rather than party tickets, and voters could split support across lists within a district. There were no party organisations,

whips, or binding manifestos. MPs attached to patrons who mediated access to offices, contracts, public works, and fiscal relief.

Hering (1992) provides the most comprehensive account of this factional structure, documenting how parties represented shifting coalitions of notables and their respective clienteles rather than clearly defined ideological platforms. Political boundaries between the Trikoupis and Deligiannis camps, while real, were deeply blurred by overlapping patronage ties and local power structures. Campbell and Sherrard (1968) reinforce this picture of patronage-sustained discipline, describing how under Trikoupis's majority governments MPs faced strong incentives to maintain their standing within the faction if they wished to share in the offices and favours that government controlled. Desertion on core votes was costly precisely because it threatened access to the distributive resources on which local political survival depended.

After 1883, politics concentrated in two factional poles. Trikoupis pursued fiscal centralisation and infrastructure investment financed by foreign borrowing; after his death, Georgios Theotokis became leader. Deligiannis anchored a nationalist coalition with a strong Peloponnesian base, succeeding Alexandros Koumoundouros in the early 1880s; after Deligiannis's assassination in 1905, Petros Mavromichalis became leader. In the matched data, 75.7% of MPs never switch blocs. Across the full period, 24.3% switch at least once. Switching clusters around government transitions and shock years such as 1887 and 1899.

Legislative roll calls were public. All legislative votes in the dataset are nominal and recorded with individual MP names. Secret ballots existed only for internal parliamentary elections (e.g., Speaker and committee chairs). Most parliamentary decisions were taken by standing vote, which outnumbered nominal votes by roughly eight to one, but those votes do not record individual behaviour. Public roll calls allow monitoring of individual voting.

2.2 Fiscal Arc

Trikoupis financed infrastructure through foreign borrowing. Roads tripled, the railway network reached roughly 900 kilometres, and projects included the Corinth Canal. Debt service depended on trade-linked revenues and continued access to capital markets. The export base was narrow. Currants constituted approximately 50–70 percent of Greek export value (Franghiadis 1990; Dakin 1972).

France imposed protective tariffs on imported currants in 1891 after recovering from phylloxera. The transmission mechanism was direct. French vineyards, devastated by phylloxera in the 1870s and 1880s, had created demand for Greek currants as a substitute input in wine production. As French vines recovered and domestic production resumed, France reimposed tariffs to protect its recovering wine industry. Because

currant-linked revenues—export duties, land taxes in producing regions, and customs receipts—constituted a large share of the fiscal base, the price collapse translated rapidly into a sovereign revenue crisis. The government could neither service its external debt nor substitute alternative revenue sources at sufficient scale. Currant-linked revenues were embedded in multiple fiscal instruments. Currant taxation operated through a dedicated export duty (*τέλος εξαγωγής*) levied per unit weight, the agricultural tithe (abolished in 1880 and replaced by land-area taxes), and customs-adjacent mechanisms. By 1893, reduced export receipts and constrained borrowing capacity made debt service infeasible. Trikoupi declared insolvency before the Vouli on 10 December 1893 (OS).

The war against the Ottoman Empire was declared on 6 April 1897 (OS). An armistice followed on 8 May 1897 (OS). Greece was assessed an indemnity of four million Turkish lira that it could not pay from ordinary revenues. The International Financial Commission was established by Law 2519 on 23 February 1898 (OS)¹ and placed 43 percent of state revenues under international administration. Levandis (1944) provides the standard diplomatic account of Greek external indebtedness and the Great Power negotiations that produced the IFC, documenting how British, French, and German creditor interests shaped the terms of international fiscal control. Trikoupi died in Cannes on 30 March 1896 (OS). Deligiannis was assassinated on 13 June 1905 (OS). The budget was voted article by article, ministry by ministry, rather than as an omnibus. Taxation required separate bills (*σχέδια νόμου*) distinct from appropriations.

The thirty-year period under study spans repeated alternations between the two factional leaders, punctuated by external shocks of varying type and severity. Figure 1 presents this timeline. The clustering of shocks in the 1893–1898 window (sovereign default, patron death, military defeat, and international fiscal control within five years) is what makes this period unusually informative: the same parliament and largely the same MPs experienced fiscal, military, political, and institutional shocks in rapid succession, allowing us to compare defection signatures across shock types while holding institutional context approximately constant.

¹ The date follows the parliamentary record. Some secondary sources give 26 February 1898, possibly reflecting a Gregorian conversion or a different stage of the legislative process. The date used here is taken from the Εφημερίδα των Συζητήσεων.

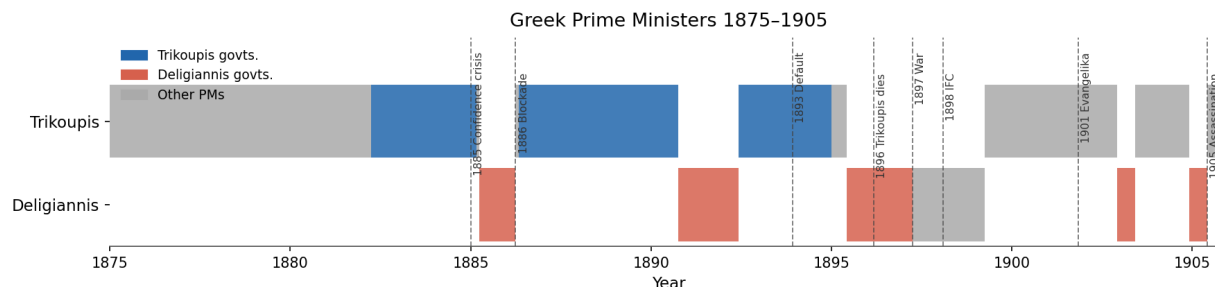


Figure 1: Political timeline, 1875–1905. Blue bars indicate Trikoupis governments; red bars indicate Deligiannis governments; grey bars indicate other prime ministers. Vertical dashed lines mark the eight shock episodes analysed in this paper. All dates are Old Style (Julian).

2.3 Peloponnese as the Patronage Heartland

Currant production was concentrated in the coastal lowlands of the northern and western Peloponnese, especially Achaia, Elis, Corinthia, Messenia, and Argolis. Interior and mountainous districts such as Arcadia, Laconia, and Mani had different economic structures. A fiscal crisis transmitted through currant-linked taxation and export instruments therefore affected Peloponnesian constituencies unevenly.

The Peloponnese also concentrated patronage-based politics. Landowning and notarial families, including the Deligiannis, Mavromichalis, and Petimezas networks, were prominent, alongside Ottoman-era tax-collector dynasties (Petropulos 1968; Mouzelis 1978). Petropulos documents the formation of these patronage networks during the early Kingdom (1833–1843); Mouzelis argues for their structural continuity through the late nineteenth century, contending that due to the absence of capitalist development, the articulation between state and society remained organised through personal clientelistic networks rather than class-based politics. Because the state apparatus remained the primary axis of economic life and industrialisation was limited, the social basis for horizontal class-based political organisation failed to consolidate. Political linkages instead crystallised into vertical patron–client networks connecting rural constituencies directly to parliamentary notables, a pattern Mouzelis treats as central to Greek political development and one that persists across the period studied here. Districts often returned multiple MPs competing for the same distributive flows. In the matched roll-call data, 32.6% of MPs represent Peloponnesian districts. The empirical design uses this geography as an exposure proxy and interacts it with vote domain to test whether shocks produce domain-specific defection.

2.4 Executive Composition and the Patronage Channel

Between 1875 and 1905, Greece cycled through 34 cabinets. The median cabinet duration was 7.5 months and the mean was 12.1 months; the longest-serving government was the Trikoupis cabinet of 1886–1890 at 53.0 months, and several

cabinets lasted under a month. By comparison, postwar parliamentary governments in Western Europe typically survive eighteen to twenty-four months (Müller and Strøm 2000), and Warwick (1992) shows that economic deterioration significantly increases the hazard of government termination in those systems. The Greek figure places the Vouli at the extreme end of executive instability, making the persistence of cross-domain voting structure documented in Section 5 all the more anomalous.

Shock	Date (OS)	PM in office	Governing bloc	Cabinet transition $\pm 3m$
1885 confidence crisis	1885-02-05	Trikoupis	T	Yes
1886 blockade	1886-04-26	Deligiannis	D	Yes
1893 default	1893-12-10	Trikoupis	T	Yes
1896 Trikoupis death	1896-03-30	Deligiannis	D	No
1897 war	1897-04-06	Deligiannis	D	Yes
1898 IFC	1898-02-23	Zaimis	Independent	No
1901 Evangelika	1901-11-08	Theotokis	T	Yes
1905 assassination	1905-06-13	Deligiannis	D	Yes

Table 1: Shock-to-Government Mapping

Note: Zaimis was a Crown-appointed transitional PM who appears in both T-bloc and D-bloc alignments across different periods; he is classified as independent rather than assigned to either bloc. The Evangelika transition reflects the fall of the Theotokis government, with Zaimis succeeding four days later on 12 November 1901. Deligiannis was the PM in office at the time of his assassination on 13 June 1905 (OS). Sources disagree on the precise date of the formal transition to Rallis; some give 9 June, others place the succession immediately after the assassination on 13 June.

Six of the eight shock episodes coincide with a cabinet transition within three months. The two exceptions are analytically informative. Trikoupis's death in March 1896 occurred while Deligiannis was securely in office with 22 months of tenure remaining, meaning the T-bloc budget collapse documented in Section 7.2 cannot be attributed to a simultaneous loss of government. The IFC in February 1898 was imposed during a stable Zaimis caretaker cabinet, so the disappearance of the fiscal defection margin after 1898 reflects the removal of the fiscal arena rather than a change of government. For the remaining six episodes, the co-occurrence of shock and cabinet transition means that the overall defection level (β_1 in the regression specifications) partly reflects government change, reinforcing the caution already noted in Section 2.1 about interpreting cross-episode levels rather than domain-specific interactions.

The governing-bloc column also clarifies the direction of the main results. The 1893 default occurred under a T-bloc government; the Peloponnesian MPs who defected on taxation were T-bloc members breaking from their own governing faction, a pattern that fits patronage strain rather than opposition behaviour. The 1896 budget collapse occurred while the T-bloc was in opposition under Deligiannis, meaning the loss of Trikoupis as a coordinating patron disrupted an opposition bloc's ability to maintain coherent positions on complex legislative business.

A natural question is whether the patronage channel was concentrated in one bloc. Matching Finance and Interior portfolio holders during 1875–1905 to roll-call bloc assignments yields 68 of 70 minister-appointments matched (97.1 percent).² The results show no significant differential allocation: the D-bloc held 17 Finance and 19 Interior appointments, while the T-bloc held 14 of each ($\chi^2 = 0.049$, $p = 0.83$). Both blocs used these portfolios as patronage vehicles when in government. This symmetry supports the empirical design in Sections 6–7, which identifies defection through geographic exposure and domain variation rather than through bloc-level differences in patronage access.

Bloc assignment	Finance	Interior	Total	Match status
D-bloc	17	19	36	matched
T-bloc	14	14	28	matched
Unaffiliated (Crown transitional)	—	—	4	matched
Unmatched	—	—	2	unmatched
Total	31	33	70	97.1% matched

Table 2: Finance and Interior Portfolio Appointments by Bloc, 1875–1905

Note: Counts reflect minister-appointments (not unique individuals) for the Finance and Interior portfolios. Of 70 appointments, 68 are matched to roll-call bloc assignments (97.1 percent). The null of equal allocation across blocs is not rejected ($\chi^2 = 0.049$, $p = 0.83$) based on the 2×2 table of bloc (T/D) by portfolio (Finance/Interior) among matched appointments.

3. Theoretical Framework

3.1 Standard Prediction: Fiscal Crisis Forces Programmatic Transition

The prediction tested here follows Kitschelt’s (2000, pp. 856–857) “resource argument.” Clientelism is constrained by a budget constraint: selective benefits are costly, and monitoring and brokerage require resources that compete with broad public goods. As resources contract, the marginal cost per vote of clientelism rises relative to programmatic alternatives (Kitschelt and Wilkinson 2007; Stokes et al. 2013, ch. 2).

Kitschelt frames this as a long-run developmental argument, not a prediction about short-run adjustment to fiscal shocks. The mechanism is socioeconomic modernisation: as per capita income rises, citizens demand more expensive material rewards, perceive

² Four minister-appointments during this period are coded as unaffiliated with either bloc: these correspond to non-partisan figures serving in transitional cabinets installed by the Crown during periods of acute crisis (Zaimis 1897, Zaimis 1901, Nikolaos Deligiannis 1895, Deligiannis 1904). Their presence reinforces the Crown’s role as a source of institutional variation that is constant across domains within a given episode (Section 2.1).

longer causal chains from political choice, and recognise the opportunity costs of rent-seeking. Politicians must extract the contributions that feed clientelist networks from an increasingly resistant middle class; Kitschelt notes that such efforts “further enhance that group's disposition to oppose such linkage mechanisms, particularly in an economic downturn when critical groups are squeezed” (2000, p. 857). The economic-downturn clause is a parenthetical intensifier appended to a developmentalist account, not an independent causal claim about fiscal crises. Kitschelt and Wilkinson (2007, ch. 1) further complicate the resource argument, making development interactively conditional on electoral competitiveness, governance structures, and ethnic heterogeneity rather than a standalone cause of programmatic transition. In a later project report, Kitschelt states explicitly that “periods of economic crisis offer windows of opportunity to raise the programmatic content of party competition. When the status quo becomes painful, both voters and politicians are willing to consider policy programs that affect the benefits and costs of large voter groups, while funds for clientelistic exchanges are disappearing” (Kitschelt and Wang 2012, p. 5). This is the closest the literature comes to the prediction tested here, but it remains a claim about party-system form rather than within-parliament voting behaviour. The present paper brings the claim down to the legislative level, using roll-call data, constituency-cost heterogeneity surfaced by agenda content, decomposed by within-region (Coast vs Interior) contrasts, and within-session domain comparisons that hold the chamber's circumstances constant while bill content varies.

Kitschelt himself acknowledges the modernisation theory's anomalies—Japan, Italy, and Austria remain clientelist despite high income; the Baltic states are more programmatic than Russia and Ukraine at comparable income levels—and concludes that none of his reviewed theories is fully encompassing (2000, pp. 858–860).

The clientelism literature does not specify a sharp roll-call implication of fiscal crisis. It does not state whether adjustment should appear first in fiscal domains, whether it should generalise across the agenda, or whether it should persist. The Greek data allow a test using within-parliament domain variation and post-shock persistence.

3.1.1 Model of Patronage-Bound Voting

To formalise roll-call implications, voting is modelled as a mixture of ideological agreement and patronage compliance. For MP i on roll call v , let $Y_{iv} = 1$ denote a vote that follows the bloc line, and assume

$$P(Y_{iv} = 1) = \sigma(\alpha_v + \kappa[(1 - b_i)\lambda_i^{ideo} + b_i \lambda_i^{patron}] \ell_{z_i,v} + \beta x_v (\theta_{i,d(v)} - \varphi_{z_i,t,d(v)}))$$

Here, $\sigma(\cdot)$ is the logistic link, α_v is a vote-specific intercept, $\ell_{z_i,v}$ is the bloc line, and x_v scales domain salience. Let $b_i \in [0, 1]$ denote MP i 's patronage dependence. When b_i is high, compliance is sustained primarily through exchange. The term λ_i^{patron} captures patronage-based loyalty and is scaled by patronage capacity R_t at time t . The term λ_i^{ideo}

captures ideological loyalty. The spatial component $\theta_{i,d(v)} - \phi_{zi,t,d(v)}$ measures distance between MP i 's ideal point and the bloc position in domain $d(v)$.

When R_t is high and b_i is high, the patronage term can sustain compliance even when $\theta_{i,d(v)}$ diverges from $\phi_{zi,t,d(v)}$. A fiscal crisis reduces R_t and weakens patronage compliance for MPs with high b_i . The behavioural effect is domain-specific because defection requires nonzero domain distance. The implication is that defection increases in domains where constituency interests conflict with the bloc line. In the Greek setting, this implies post-default defection on currant-targeting legislation when such legislation reaches the floor, concentrated among currant-coast Peloponnesian MPs whose constituencies bear the targeted cost, with high cohesion on fiscal business that does not engage location-specific heterogeneity (including most ordinary fiscal business) and high cohesion on governance, military, and procedural votes (where the position-forcing mechanism is absent and the patron's absorption channels remain intact). The prediction therefore generates both within-fiscal refinement (defection on currant-targeting taxation, not on taxation broadly) and cross-domain selectivity (procedural and governance votes hold even in the same sittings as taxation defection). Cox and McCubbins's (2005) agenda-control mechanism could also generate cohesion, but the Vouli lacked strong formal agenda-control institutions, and opposition demands for nominal roll calls made selection into recorded votes responsive to contestation.

The reduced-form specifications in Sections 6–7 do not estimate structural parameters. Peloponnese geography proxies for high patronage dependence. The interaction $\text{Post} \times \text{Pelop} \times \text{Taxation}$ captures the joint effect of reduced patronage capacity after the fiscal shock and domain-specific conflict between constituency interests and the bloc line. The model motivates these interactions.³

3.2 π -Pattern and π -Binding: Decomposing the Single Latent

The standard framework treats the transition from clientelism to programmatic politics as movement along a single latent variable governing how bloc vote lines are generated (Kitschelt 2000; Kitschelt and Wilkinson 2007). For each vote v in period t , bloc k 's line is

³ The affiliation utility in the model specification treats switching costs as exogenous. An extension would endogenise switching costs as a function of market structure: when two competing patrons exist, the outside option is credible and switching costs are low; when one patron exits, switching costs rise for MPs in the surviving faction (no credible defection threat) and fall for MPs in the dead patron's faction (the surviving patron is the only available destination, reducing their bargaining power). This asymmetric effect on switching costs would generate the domain-specific fragmentation observed after Trikoupis's death (Section 7.2) through a market-structure mechanism rather than through coordination loss alone. Medina and Stokes (2007) model monopoly patron formation; Desposato (2006) models cascade defection when party resources decay; neither formalises the duopoly-to-monopoly transition caused by exogenous patron removal.

$$\ell_{kv} = (1 - \pi_t)u_{kv} + \pi_t x_v \varphi_{k,t,d(v)}$$

where u_{kv} is an ad hoc, vote-specific directive (patronage coordination), $x_v \cdot \varphi_{\{k,t,d(v)\}}$ is the position implied by a stable domain platform (programmatic coordination), and $d(v)$ is the policy domain of vote v . When $\pi_t \approx 0$, bloc lines are unconstrained across domains: high cohesion can coexist with zero cross-topic consistency. When $\pi_t \approx 1$, bloc lines are pinned to stable domain platforms and cross-topic consistency is high by construction. The standard prediction is that fiscal shocks reduce patronage capacity R_t , push π_t upward, and produce rising cross-domain consistency, cohesion, and organisational stability together.

The Greek data break this single-parameter prediction. Cross-topic consistency in T-bloc voting was already substantial by the early 1880s — a decade before the 1893 default (Section 5.3) — while the 1885 coalition collapse exhibited the signature of $\pi_t \approx 0$: sudden, broad-based defection across fiscal, procedural, and confidence votes (Section 5.2). The single-parameter formulation cannot accommodate a system in which observable voting patterns look programmatic but the binding mechanism is clientelist.

The decomposition replaces the single π_t with two quantities that can diverge:

$\pi_t^{pattern} \in [0,1]$: degree to which observed bloc voting is cross-domain consistent

$b_i \in [0,1]$: MP i 's patronage dependence

The bloc-line equation is preserved with $\pi_t^{pattern}$ in place of π_t . The system-level quantity $\pi^{binding}$ ⁴ is derived rather than primitive: it is the b_i -weighted average compliance mechanism across coalition members, summarising the composition rather than introducing a new structural parameter. A coalition is patronage-bound when most of its members have high b_i — when most compliance flows through exchange rather than commitment.

The two quantities can diverge in either direction. A patron imposing a coherent cross-domain agenda — vote with me on fiscal policy, vote with me on military spending, vote with me on judicial appointments — generates high $\pi^{pattern}$ through deliberately patterned u_{kv} values, while the b_i distribution remains concentrated at high values. The votes look programmatic; the compliance mechanism is patronage. The mirror image is

⁴ Kitschelt and Wilkinson (2007) use the term ‘linkage mechanisms’ to distinguish programmatic from clientelistic accountability relationships between parties and voters. The present paper’s ‘ π -binding’ is a formalisation of this distinction applied to within-legislature compliance rather than voter-party linkage. The terminology differs — ‘binding’ rather than ‘linkage’ — because the object of analysis is the mechanism enforcing MP compliance with the bloc line, not the accountability relationship between parties and their electoral base.

a fragmented programmatic party in which b_i is low for most members but π^{pattern} is depressed by intra-party policy disagreement.

Under normal conditions, π^{pattern} and the b_i distribution are not separately identified from observed votes. They are identified at moments of stress, when the binding channel is disrupted and the coalition's response reveals whether compliance was transactional or commitment-based. This is the Krehbiel (1993) identification problem restated for clientelism: high observed cohesion is consistent with either a disciplined party or a patron-coordinated network, and the distinguishing variation comes from exogenous shocks. Eggers and Spirling (2014) show that rising cohesion in the Victorian House of Commons reflected efficient whipping rather than ideological selection of MPs; Kam (2009) provides the theoretical framework for the discipline-vs-preference-homogeneity distinction.⁵ The decomposition developed here extends this logic to a setting where the compliance mechanism is patronage exchange rather than party discipline, and uses domain-specific shock signatures rather than turnover decomposition to separate the channels.

The framework's apparatus is silent on R_t 's dynamics: b_i describes how an MP weights patron-aligned vs constituency-aligned voting, and R_t describes the patron's effective override capacity for a given vote, but the framework's earlier paragraphs do not specify how R_t evolves over time or across bills. The dynamic specification I adopt is agenda-conditional. Define the patron's absorption channels as the set of instruments through which a patron can keep an MP's vote aligned with the bloc despite constituency-cost pressure: trades, side payments, procedural accommodations, log-rolls, and substitutions of less costly votes for more costly ones. Most legislative business does not force MPs into a public position-taking moment that conflicts with their constituency, and the patron's absorption channels remain intact; on such votes, R_t is operationally high. Position-forcing legislation — bills that publicly name and tax specific constituencies, requiring affected MPs to vote yes or no on a record bearing those constituents' costs — eliminates the absorption channels for those MPs on that bill, because no procedural accommodation lets a current-coast MP vote yes on a bill taxing current producers without his constituents seeing the vote. R_t is operationally low for affected MPs on the bill while it is on the floor, and returns to high once the bill leaves the agenda.

Under high b_i (patronage binding), defection appears when position-forcing legislation reaches the floor, concentrated among MPs whose constituencies bear the targeted cost; defection is silent on votes that do not produce position-forcing moments, including

⁵ Kam (2009) and Carey (2009) distinguish cohesion (observed voting agreement within a group) from discipline (enforcement of a line by leaders, regardless of members' preferences). The π -pattern corresponds to cohesion; π -binding corresponds to discipline.

most ordinary fiscal business; defection recurs whenever such legislation returns to the agenda. Gaps between defection clusters are not failures of the prediction but instances of it: agenda quiet implies absorption channels intact, which implies discipline holds.

Under low b_i (programmatic binding), defection should track prior preference distance — the MP's pre-shock divergence from the bloc platform on the relevant domain — and should appear on votes that engage that prior preference, regardless of whether they produce position-forcing moments for the MP's constituency. Low- b_i defection persists across votes within a domain because preference structure does not change with agenda content.

The discriminator between high- b_i and low- b_i is therefore structural rather than temporal: high- b_i defection is agenda-tracking and constituency-conditional; low- b_i defection is preference-tracking and constituency-independent.

The same mechanism explains a complementary case: patron death (the 1896 episode treated in §7.2). Position-forcing legislation removes absorption capacity for affected MPs on specific bills; patron death removes absorption capacity wholesale across all votes the patron coordinated. Under high b_i , the result in the patron-death case is b_i heterogeneity surfacing across the patron-coordinated domain (budget allocation, in the 1896 case), without bill-by-bill selectivity, because the absorption-capacity loss is not bill-conditional. The 1894–1895 currant clusters and the 1896 budget collapse are two readings on the same R_t mechanism — selective surfacing through agenda content in the first case, wholesale surfacing through patron removal in the second.

The 1885 episode (Section 5.2) is the motivating case for the decomposition: cross-domain structure was present in the pre-shock period (high π^{pattern}) but failed simultaneously across all domains when political authority was challenged. This is the signature of high b_i under shock to R_t , not of low b_i under programmatic disagreement.

Negative agenda control could also produce observed cohesion by preventing divisive proposals from reaching the floor (Cox and McCubbins 2005). The Greek parliament lacked formal agenda-control institutions comparable to the U.S. Rules Committee, and the opposition could demand nominal votes in contested moments (e.g., the Choidas episode in 1885). Nominal votes are also selected on contestation, which limits inference about routine business but focuses attention on cases where enforcement is tested.

3.3 Predictions by Shock Type

The π -decomposition maps shock types to functions. Fiscal shocks put position-forcing constituency-targeting legislation onto the parliamentary agenda; when such legislation is on the floor, the patron's instruments for absorbing constituency-cost conflict — trades, side payments, procedural accommodations, log-rolls, substitutions — are

unavailable, and defection appears among MPs whose constituencies bear the targeted cost; when the agenda is quiet, even within the post-shock window, defection is silent. Defection should therefore appear in clusters tracking the legislative agenda, not as a smooth post-shock spike-and-fade. Patron death removes absorption capacity wholesale across all votes the patron coordinated and should increase defection across the patron-coordinated domain (budget allocation in the Greek case), regardless of bill-by-bill content. Confidence crises undermine political authority and should increase defection uniformly across domains.

Shock type	Patron function disrupted	Predicted defection pattern
Confidence crisis	Focal-point loyalty	Uniform cross-domain collapse
Fiscal shock	Agenda produces position-forcing constituency-targeting legislation	Coast-specific defection on targeting bills, silent between clusters and on non-targeting fiscal business
Patron death	Loss of absorption capacity wholesale across patron-coordinated domain	Chamber-wide defection on patron-coordinated domain (budget allocation), regardless of bill-by-bill content
Non-economic crisis	No agenda-mediated position-forcing trigger	Null
Fiscal arena removed	Position-forcing legislation removed from parliamentary agenda	Mechanism unobservable; no triggering bills reach the floor
External military threat	Focal-point loyalty reinforced	Fiscal tightening (rally)

Table 3: Predictions by shock type

The empirical design evaluates whether observed defection signatures match Table 3 across distinct shocks. A mismatch is informative. For example, a fiscal shock that produces cross-domain collapse would contradict the patronage-binding account.

The idea that legislative cohesion varies by policy domain has precedent. Jessee and Theriault (2014) show that party polarisation in the US Congress is systematically greater on procedural votes than on final-passage votes. Dewan and Spirling (2011) find that government cohesion in Westminster on budget and confidence votes is structurally higher than on policy votes due to agenda-setting rules. Sieberer (2006) reports cross-nationally that party unity on financially salient votes is systematically higher than on other domains in European parliaments. The present paper extends this literature in two ways: it decomposes cohesion by domain to infer the compliance mechanism rather than to describe institutional effects, and it uses exogenous shocks to identify which domain signature corresponds to which binding mechanism.

3.4 What the Theory Does Not Predict

Several components of the original framework are not implemented. The structural voting model is not estimated. Endogenous faction detection via SVD is not implemented; blocs are assigned using leader-anchored agreement scoring. Speech–

vote alignment requires a digitised debate corpus. Coding bill sponsorship (government versus opposition) is not available. These components are separate from the reduced-form identification strategy used here.

Of the structural quantities defined in §3.2, neither π^{pattern}_t nor the b_i distribution is estimated structurally in this paper. What is estimated are reduced-form quantities implied by the structural model: domain-specific Rice scores by bloc and period (a coarsening of π^{pattern}_t), within-bloc cross-domain correlations $\rho_k^{d_1, d_2}$ where sample size permits (a direct observable counterpart to π^{pattern}_t), and the three mechanism tests in §7.4 that probe the shape of the b_i distribution under stress. The reduced-form approach is conservative: it does not pin down the parameters but tests whether the observed defection signatures match the predictions implied by alternative parameter regimes. A structural estimation that recovers b_i at the MP level — using a panel that spans multiple shocks to R_t — is feasible in principle but is left to future work.

4. Data

4.1 Parliamentary Records and Roll Call Extraction

The roll-call data come from the *Εφημερίδα των Συζητήσεων* (the official record of parliamentary debates), held at the Library of the Hellenic Parliament. I use digitised session texts corresponding to volumes 100289–100331, covering 1,026 sessions between 1875 and 1905. The documents are printed in polytonic Greek and list nominal votes as sequences of MP names under headings for “yes,” “no,” “formal abstention” (ἀρν.), and absence. An OCR and parsing pipeline extracts individual name strings and vote categories and converts them into a vote-level panel in which the unit of observation is an MP–roll-call pair. The resulting dataset contains 755 nominal roll calls and 132,246 MP–vote observations.

Each roll call is classified into a policy domain by applying an LLM to the surrounding debate text and procedural descriptions. Domain coverage is 90.5% (683 of 755 roll calls). The 72 unclassified roll calls are concentrated in the 1882–1886 volumes due to OCR quality variation; from 1887 onward, coverage ranges from 93% to 100%. Votes are coded as yes, no, formal abstention, or absent. The main analyses define defection on the yes/no margin and exclude abstentions and absences.

Nominal roll calls are a minority of parliamentary decisions. In the same volumes, there are approximately 6,124 standing votes, so nominal roll calls represent about 11% of recorded decisions (755 nominal versus ~6,124 standing). Standing votes were used for routine business; nominal votes were demanded under contestation or when leaders sought public commitment. The standing-to-nominal ratio varies from 45:1 in 1898 to 1.2:1 in 1888.

4.2 MP Registry and Name Matching

The MP registry contains 1,448 MPs across parliamentary periods 1–20 (1844–1910). OCR-extracted name strings are matched to registry entries using a four-tier cascade: Tier 1 normalised exact matches; Tier 2 abbreviation expansion; Tier 3 initial plus surname; Tier 4 Levenshtein distance ≤ 2 . Using this procedure, 1,049 unique MPs are matched, covering 96.4% of vote observations.⁶

Some cases require manual resolution. Deligiannis patronymic variants marked as B./Π. appear as distinct names in print but correspond to the same individual. Co-occurrence checks and identical voting across 301 roll calls support collapsing these records. After removing 236 duplicates, remaining unmatched names are concentrated in early-1880s OCR volumes and in rare homonym cases, which are treated as missing.

4.3 Bloc Assignment

Blocs are assigned using leader-anchored agreement scores. In a rolling 50-roll-call window, each MP's agreement rate with factional leaders is computed. The MP is assigned to the leader with higher agreement if agreement exceeds 55%; otherwise the MP is coded unaffiliated. T-bloc leaders are Trikoupis (pre-1896) and Theotokis (1896 onward). D-bloc leaders are Koumoundouros (pre-1883), Deligiannis (1883–1905), and Mavromichalis (1905 onward). Under this procedure, 87% of vote observations are assigned to T or D, and 13.1% are unaffiliated.⁷

4.4 Summary Statistics

Table 4 summarises sample characteristics. The panel contains 132,246 observations: 42,281 yes votes, 42,809 no votes, 1,400 formal abstentions, and 45,756 absences. Of bloc-assigned observations, 58,334 are T-bloc and 56,587 are D-bloc. Mean participation is 65.6%. The matched dataset includes 342 Peloponnesian MPs (32.6%). Median tenure is 5.0 years. Mean roll calls per MP is 126.1.

5. Descriptive Evidence

5.1 Factional Cohesion Over Time

Factional cohesion varies sharply over time. For each roll call, I compute the Rice index for each bloc, defined as $|yes - no| / (yes + no)$ among bloc members casting a yes or no vote (Rice 1928). Aggregated by period, the T-bloc Rice index averages 0.649 in 1875–

⁶ Roll-call coverage, bloc-assignment rates (87% assigned, 13.1% unaffiliated), and the name-matching pipeline are documented in Appendix A.4 and summarised in Table 4.

⁷ The bloc-assignment procedure, including the rolling 50-roll-call window, the 55% threshold, and the leader list, is described in Appendix A.6.

1882, rises to 0.906 in the 1883–1895 duopoly, and falls to 0.755 in 1896–1904. The corresponding D-bloc averages are 0.713, 0.827, and 0.704.

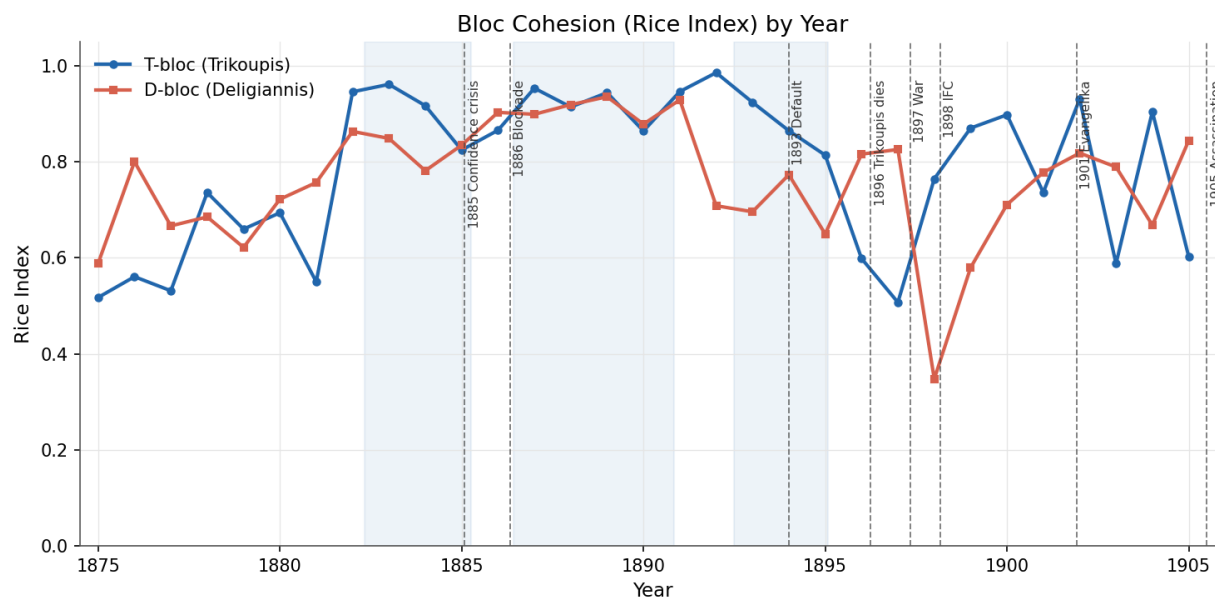


Figure 2: Bloc cohesion (Rice index) by year, 1875–1905. Blue line: T-bloc (Trikoupis/Theotokis). Red line: D-bloc (Deligiannis/Mavromichalis). Shaded bands indicate years when the T-bloc held government. Vertical dashed lines mark shock dates.

Two patterns stand out. Cohesion in both blocs increases markedly after the duopoly consolidates in 1883: T-bloc Rice rises from 0.649 (1875–1882) to 0.906 (1883–1895), while D-bloc Rice rises from 0.713 to 0.827. The governing bloc is also typically more cohesive than the opposition: the T-bloc line runs above the D-bloc line during Trikoupis governments and below it when the T-bloc is in opposition. This government–opposition asymmetry fits a patronage-binding account: the governing bloc controls offices and allocative resources while the opposition does not. After Trikoupis’s death in 1896, T-bloc cohesion drops to 0.755 and remains lower thereafter, pointing to the loss of a coordinating patron.

5.2 The 1885 Confidence Crisis: Uniform Collapse

On 5 February, Deligiannis tabled a no-confidence motion citing economic deterioration. The government fell 108–104. Seven T-bloc MPs defected, and Trikoupis abstained. Defection in this episode is not confined to fiscal votes.

Date	Topic	T-Rice	D-Rice	T defectors	Trikoupis vote
Jan 18 1885	Routine: Deputy Megaridon proposition	1.000	0.889	0	yes
Jan 23 1885	Fiscal: land tax enforcement (implicit confidence)	0.964	1.000	2	absent
Jan 24 1885	Fiscal: bill prioritisation before budget debate	0.965	1.000	2	no

Feb 5 1885	No-confidence motion (govt loses 108–104) ⁸	0.859	1.000	7	abstain
Feb 11 1885	Recall confidence motion (govt wins 116–112)	0.852	1.000	8	absent

Table 5: 1885 confidence crisis (roll-call sequence), January–February 1885. T-Rice and D-Rice are bloc-level Rice indices computed among yes/no voters. Defectors are T-bloc members voting against the T-bloc majority.

The sequence shows a gradual widening crack in the T-bloc (0, 2, 2, 7, 8 defectors) while the D-bloc maintained perfect or near-perfect discipline throughout (Rice 1.000 on every vote). The D-bloc tightening was real, not a mechanical composition effect: the D-bloc was already at maximum cohesion before any T-bloc defectors switched sides. Trikoupis's own trajectory is revealing: he voted with his bloc on January 18 and January 24, was absent on January 23 (the first day defections appeared), abstained on February 5 (the no-confidence vote his government lost), and was absent on February 11 (the recall confidence vote). The PM's progressive withdrawal from voting (present, absent, present, abstain, absent) suggests a controlled retreat, not a sudden collapse. Defection was also not confined to any single policy domain: the January 23–24 votes were fiscal (tax enforcement, budget prioritisation), while February 5 and February 11 were confidence motions cutting across domains. This broad-based breakdown matches the uniform-collapse signature implied by the patronage-binding framework when political authority is challenged. After the opposition declined to form a government, Trikoupis won the recall vote 116–112 and dissolved parliament; the eight defectors on February 11 were different individuals from the seven on February 5.⁹

During this sequence, D-bloc Rice remains 1.000. Five MPs permanently switch from T to D between December 1884 and March 1885. The episode's defections are not concentrated in fiscal votes; the pattern points to an authority shock rather than a domain-specific resource shock.

5.3 Cross-Topic Consistency

Across domains, defection rates are correlated but far from perfectly aligned. The mean pairwise correlation is 0.34 in the full sample, rising to 0.44 during 1883–1895 and

⁸ Some sources place the no-confidence division on 4 February, with the formal resignation on 5 February. The parliamentary record (Εφημερίδα των Συζητήσεων) is the authoritative source for the precise date; both dates appear in the secondary literature.

⁹ Gardikas-Katsiadakis (1988) analyses the 1875–1885 decade as a period of transition toward a two-party system, but explicitly cautions that 'it is therefore too early in the history of the cultural definition of interest differentiations to ascribe voting behaviour to class conscious political preferences on a national scale.' She emphasises that local parties remained personal followings of political figures rather than representatives of national issues. The domain-uniform defection pattern in Table 5 is consistent with her caution: the 1885 collapse reflects the fragility of patron-centred coordination rather than the emergence of programmatic alignment.

falling to 0.30 in 1896–1905. The strongest pairing is budget $\times$ taxation ($r = 0.67$). After 1896 the correlations weaken, pointing to reduced coordination in fiscal domains.

5.4 Open versus Closed Votes

All 755 legislative roll calls in the dataset are nominal and publicly recorded. Secret ballots appear only for internal parliamentary elections (1,312 entries), used for positions such as the Speaker and committee chairs. There is no secret-ballot procedure for policy votes. Public roll calls provide observable signals of MP loyalty. Standing votes are more frequent, roughly eight standing votes for every nominal roll call, but they yield only aggregate outcomes (approved/rejected).

6. Empirical Strategy

6.1 Identification

The primary shock is the 1893 sovereign default. Trikoupis declared insolvency on 10 December 1893 (OS) after the collapse of currant-linked revenues and binding debt arithmetic. The timing is plausibly exogenous to individual MPs. The design is a triple-difference exploiting time variation around the default, Peloponnese geography as an exposure proxy, and vote domain (fiscal versus non-fiscal).

The design is a triple-difference (Gruber 1994; Olden and Møen 2022): the Peloponnese-level main effect (β_2) absorbs the average post-default elevation in Peloponnesian defection across all domains, MP fixed effects absorb time-invariant MP-level confounders including any structural compliance gap, domain fixed effects absorb cross-domain compositional differences, and the identifying variation is in β_3 — the within-MP, within-domain elevation in post-period defection on taxation specifically. The triple-difference identification assumption requires that, absent the default, the Peloponnese-versus-rest gap on fiscal votes would have evolved similarly to the Peloponnese-versus-rest gap on non-fiscal votes; this is weaker than parallel-trends, which would require the Peloponnese-versus-rest fiscal gap itself to be stable over time. The cross-domain difference-in-differences is plausible here because the Peloponnese-versus-rest gap on non-fiscal votes shows no comparable secular trend in the pre-period, and the cross-domain differential is what the framework predicts should respond to currant-targeting legislation reaching the floor. §3.2 predicts that under high b_i , MPs whose constituencies are most directly absorbed into patronage networks should show higher compliance on ordinary fiscal business than MPs in less patronage-bound regions, because the patron's absorption channels handle routine fiscal votes; therefore a long-run Peloponnese-versus-rest fiscal compliance gap should be present in the pre-period data, with Peloponnesian MPs more compliant. This is what the pre-period diagnostics show: the monthly pre-trend F-test rejects ($F = 9.54$, $p < 0.001$) and the

quarterly version also rejects ($F = 6.76$, $p < 0.001$), and the violation is driven by negative pre-period coefficients across 1885–1893 — including zero defectors on taxation votes in March 1890 and July 1892 with 50 and 68 voters respectively — indicating Peloponnesian MPs were systematically more compliant on fiscal votes than the rest of the chamber throughout the pre-shock decade. The pre-trend test is not the right diagnostic for the design: it tests parallel trends, which is the wrong assumption for a triple-difference estimator; what it does test is whether the structural gap §3.2 predicts is empirically present, and it is. The design accommodates this by absorbing the gap in level through MP fixed effects, with β_3 carrying the identifying variation as the within-MP within-domain post-period elevation on taxation.

Identification rests on convergence across three strands that exploit independent sources of variation. Strand 1 is panel-level: the regression elevation $\beta_3 = +0.073$ ($p = 0.006$), reported in §7.1, identifies the within-MP within-domain post-period elevation in fiscal defection against the structural baseline. Strand 2 is within-region cross-bill: holding Peloponnese constant and varying constituency exposure within it, Coast Peloponnesian MPs broke discipline at 13.0–47% across the March 1894 and July 1895 currant-targeting clusters while interior Peloponnesian MPs voted with the bloc at 0% defection across the same six votes (§7.5 ¶583, §7.1 Table 7). The within-region asymmetry absorbs Peloponnese-level confounders that any factor common to all Peloponnesian MPs would predict equally for Coast and Interior. Strand 3 is within-session within-bill-content: at the March 5, 1894 sitting, the same MPs maintained Rice cohesion of 1.000 on a procedural motion alongside Rice 0.86–0.90 on three consecutive currant-tax votes minutes earlier (Table 6). Strand 3 documents the pattern at one specific sitting and is generalised by the framework to the broader claim about position-forcing legislation; it operates on a smaller analytical surface than Strands 1 and 2, but absorbs a distinct threat — time-varying chamber-level confounders that any factor specific to the political moment would predict similarly across domains within a sitting. The three strands work together because they exploit different sources of variation, not because they are three iterations of the same identification logic at different scales: panel-level estimation, within-region cross-bill comparison, and within-session within-bill-content contrast. A reviewer attacking any single strand still has to explain the convergence across all three on the §3.2 prediction.

The empirical strategy includes a domain-specificity test using a variable `DomainDev_id` — MP i 's pre-shock dissent rate in domain d relative to their overall pre-shock dissent rate — that combines the domain-decomposition tradition (Jessee and Theriault 2014; Kirkland and Slapin 2017) with the pre/post loyalty-score approach. The interaction $\text{Post} \times \text{Peloponnese} \times \text{DomainDev}$ (denoted β_6 in the specification) is a Krehbiel-style identification test: under high b_i (patronage binding), β_6 should be null because defection is not predicted by prior domain-specific disagreement; under low b_i

(programmatic binding), β_6 should be positive because MPs who already diverged on a domain break first. Results are reported in §7.4 alongside the geography-vs-prior-dissent regression and the Low Alignment interaction, as a unified set of mechanism inferences about the b_i distribution.

6.2 Specification

The baseline specification is a linear probability model with MP fixed effects and domain fixed effects. $Defect_{ivt}$ equals 1 if MP i casts a yes/no vote against the majority of their assigned bloc on roll call v at time t , and 0 otherwise. Abstentions and absences are excluded. The estimating equation is

$$Defect_{ivt} = \alpha_i + \beta_1 Post_t + \beta_2 (Post_t \times Pelop_i) + \beta_3 (Post_t \times Pelop_i \times Taxation_v) + \delta_d + \varepsilon_{ivt}$$

A note on the time dimension. The unit of observation is MP $i \times$ roll call v . The variable T in the specification refers to calendar year (or, in the event study, a 12-month bin centred on the shock date), which is a coarsening of V . The domain fixed effects δ_d absorb average domain-level variation in defection. A full set of roll-call fixed effects would absorb the event-time (τ) indicators, because τ is assigned at the roll-call date; the event-study coefficients would therefore not be identified. Section B.4 of the appendix reports a month-year fixed effects diagnostic as a feasible coarser substitute.

α_i are MP fixed effects and δ_d are domain fixed effects. $Post_t$ indicates dates on or after 10 December 1893. $Pelop_i$ indicates a Peloponnesian district. $Taxation_v$ indicates the taxation domain. Standard errors are clustered at the MP level. β_3 is the $Post \times Pelop \times Taxation$ interaction.

For budget-process outcomes, $Taxation_v$ is replaced with $Budget_v$. The sign differs across fiscal subdomains. A robustness check uses a six-month window (pre: 1893-07 to 1893-11; post: 1893-12 to 1894-05). In this window, $\beta_3 = +0.074$ ($p < 0.001$) and β_1 is statistically insignificant.

6.3 Additional Shocks as Robustness

Eight episodes are examined: 1885 confidence crisis, 1886 blockade with government change, 1893 default, 1896 Trikoupis death, 1897 war, 1898 International Financial Commission, 1901 Evangelika riots, and 1905 assassination. For episodes other than 1893, a lean specification uses $Post \times Pelop \times Fiscal$. Episode limitations include 55% domain coverage in the 1885 window, no fiscal roll calls in 1886 itself, small post samples in 1896 and 1897, and three post-period roll calls in 1905.

The within-Peloponnesian Coast/Interior decomposition is the primary specification used in §7.1 to identify constituency-cost heterogeneity on currant-targeting legislation; this

section's Peloponnese-bloc specification is retained for cross-episode comparability across the eight cases. The two specifications do complementary work: §7.1 identifies the constituency-cost mechanism within the 1893 window, while §6.3 tests the §3.3 Table 3 predictions about which shock types should and should not activate that mechanism. Whether each episode produces the signature predicted for its type — Coast-specific defection on currant-targeting bills for the 1893 default, chamber-wide budget defection for the 1896 patron-removal, nulls for shocks without position-forcing legislation on the agenda — is the structural question §6.3 addresses across episodes, and a Peloponnese-bloc specification is the appropriate unit for that comparison.

6.4 Agnostic Leader Similarity

The bloc-based defection measure requires pre-assigning each MP to a bloc, which introduces endogeneity: an MP who drifts away from the bloc majority is simultaneously reclassified and recorded as non-defecting. To address this, I construct a bloc-free similarity index. For each MP i , each roll call v , and each named leader L , I define:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{agree}_{ivL} &= 1 \quad \text{if } \text{vote}_i = \text{vote}_L \text{ on roll call } v \\ \text{agree}_{ivL} &= 0 \quad \text{otherwise} \end{aligned}$$

No bloc assignment is made. The regression is:

$$\text{agree}_{ivL} = \alpha_i + \sum_{\tau \neq -1} \beta_{\tau} \cdot 1[\tau_{\text{bin}(v)} = \tau] + \varepsilon_{ivL}$$

where $\tau_{\text{bin}(v)} \in \{-3, -2, -1, 0, +1, +2\}$ assigns roll call v to a 12-month window relative to the shock date (10 December 1893), with $\tau=-1$ (December 1892–December 1893) as the omitted reference. α_i are MP fixed effects estimated by within-demeaning. Standard errors are clustered at the MP level. The specification is run separately for each of eight historically documented leaders — Trikoupis, Deligiannis, Theotokis, Mavromichalis, Zaimis, Rallis, Konstantopoulos, and Sotiropoulos — and for each policy domain. This produces a full event study per leader $\times$ domain cell.

The estimating sample is restricted to roll calls within the ± 3 -year window around the 1893 shock. Some leaders cannot be estimated in the event-study specification because the $\tau=-1$ reference bin is empty. In particular, Mavromichalis, Zaimis, and Sotiropoulos have zero observations in $\tau=-1$, so the event study is not estimable for them. These cases are handled separately in Appendix D.

7. Results

7.1 Main Result: Constituency-Targeting Legislation and Coast-Specific Defection (1893–1895)

Post-default Coast-specific defection on currant-targeting legislation appears in two clusters separated by sixteen months, with largely null fiscal months between them. The first is the March 5, 1894 tax-relief cluster: three consecutive tax-relief proposals for currant-producing provinces voted in a single sitting. Coast Peloponnesian MPs broke discipline at 13.0%, 23.8%, and 26.3% across the three votes (aggregate 13/63 = 20.6%); interior Peloponnesian MPs voted with the bloc at 0% defection on all three (0/28 aggregate). Sixteen months later, on July 11–12, 1895, the chamber returned to currant taxation in a cluster of three roll calls culminating in the third reading of the currant-taxation bill (φορολογίας τοῦ σταφιδοκάρπου). Coast defection on this cluster ran at 38.9%, 46.7%, and 19.0% (aggregate 25/69 = 36.2%); interior defection was again 0/45 across all three votes. The two clusters share a legislative profile — consecutive currant-tax roll calls in a single sitting — and a defection signature: Coast breaks, Interior holds. Table 7 reports the cell-by-cell decomposition.

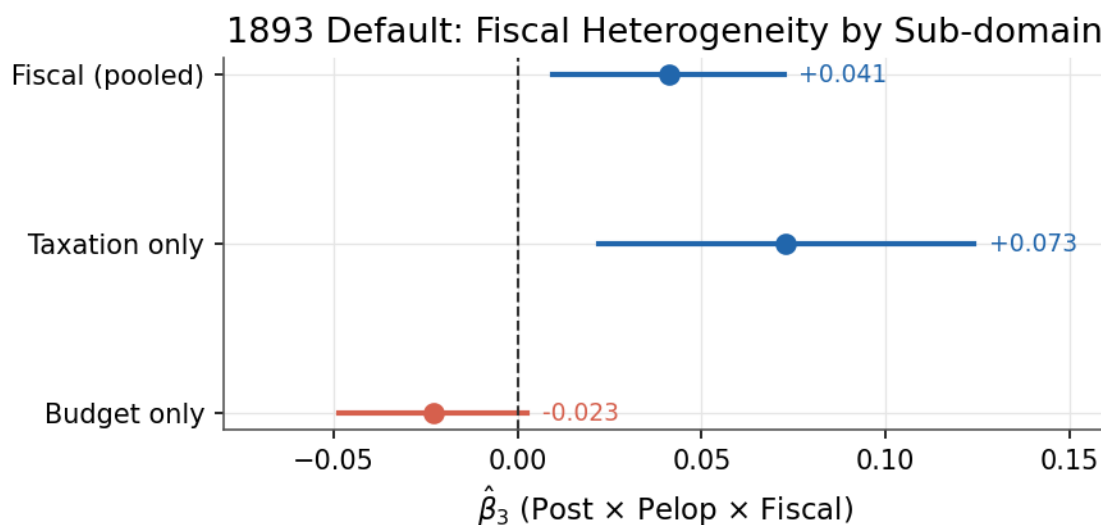


Figure 3: Domain Decomposition of the Post-Default Defection Effect. Horizontal bars show the Post $\times$ Peloponnesian $\times$ Domain interaction coefficient with 95% confidence intervals. The taxation coefficient (+0.073) is a domain-level summary of the cluster-level evidence presented in Table 7: post-default Coast-specific defection on currant-targeting legislation, concentrated in the March 5, 1894 tax-relief cluster and the July 11–12, 1895 σταφιδοκάρπου cluster. The budget coefficient (−0.023) is taken up in §7.2.

Two days before the March 5 cluster, the chamber voted on a Messinezis tax-relief proposal for currant-producing provinces (March 3, 1894). The defection pattern on that

vote is partially asymmetric rather than cleanly asymmetric: Coast defection was 33.3%, but Interior defection was 16.7% — both sides defected, with Coast roughly twice the Interior rate. The contrast between March 3 (partially asymmetric, both sides defecting) and March 5 (cleanly asymmetric, Interior holding at zero) is informative for what the structural claim says it should be. The asymmetric Coast-vs-Interior signature is not produced by general post-default chamber stress, which would predict similar patterns on closely-spaced fiscal votes; it is produced by specific bill content. The Messinezis proposal and the March 5 proposals differed in their distributive consequences within currant-producing provinces, and the chamber's defection pattern tracked that difference within forty-eight hours.

The February 22, 1894 παρακράτησις vote — the Trikoupis withholding bill, a contested currant-policy measure that did not impose location-specific costs on currant-producing provinces — shows the symmetric pattern that distinguishes preference disagreement from constituency-targeting defection. Coast defection was 36.4%; Interior defection was 37.5%. The two rates differ by roughly one percentage point. T-bloc Rice on this vote falls to 0.25 with 28 defectors chamber-wide, ten of them from the Peloponnese — a high-defection vote at the chamber level, but symmetric across the within-Peloponnese coast/interior boundary. This is the within-region preference benchmark for the analysis: when currant-producing MPs disagree about a currant-policy bill that does not impose location-specific costs, both Coast and Interior defect at similar rates because both sides hold genuine preferences about the policy mechanism. Two and a half weeks later, the same chamber records sharply asymmetric Coast-vs-Interior defection on the March 5 tax-relief cluster. Within a fortnight, the chamber records bilateral preference disagreement on a non-targeting currant-policy vote and asymmetric Coast-specific defection on currant-targeting bills. This contrast is the identification logic the section relies on: bilateral defection is what genuine preference heterogeneity looks like in this chamber, and asymmetric Coast/Interior defection on currant-targeting bills is what constituency-cost heterogeneity looks like. This contrast — symmetric defection on contested currant-policy votes alongside asymmetric defection on currant-targeting bills — is the empirical signature of a layered pattern §7.5 documents at the moderator level.

RC ID	Domain	Fiscal?	T-Rice	T voters	T defectors	Pelop T defectors
100316_s72_r7	taxation	yes	0.899	99	5	3
100316_s72_r9	taxation	yes	0.864	103	7	5
100316_s72_r11	taxation	yes	0.860	100	7	5
100316_s72_r12	procedural	no	1.000	100	0	0

Table 6: Within-Session Domain Contrast, March 5, 1894. All roll calls from the same parliamentary session, with the same MPs present. Taxation votes show low T-bloc cohesion; the procedural vote shows perfect discipline.

RC ID	Date	Bill	Coast defection	Interior defection
March 5, 1894 — tax-relief cluster (asymmetric)				
100316_s72_r7	Mar 5, 1894	Currant tax-relief proposal	13.0%	0%
100316_s72_r9	Mar 5, 1894	Currant tax-relief proposal	23.8%	0%
100316_s72_r11	Mar 5, 1894	Currant tax-relief proposal	26.3%	0%
<i>Aggregate (Coast 13/63, Interior 0/28)</i>			20.6%	0%
July 11–12, 1895 — σταφιδοκάρπου cluster (asymmetric)				
100318_s46_r3	Jul 11, 1895	σταφιδοκάρπου	38.9%	0%
100318_s46_r4	Jul 11, 1895	σταφιδοκάρπου	46.7%	0%
100318_s47_r0	Jul 12, 1895	σταφιδοκάρπου, third reading	19.0%	0%
<i>Aggregate (Coast 25/69, Interior 0/45)</i>			36.2%	0%
February 22, 1894 — παρακράτησις withholding bill (symmetric benchmark)				
100316_s62_r0	Feb 22, 1894	Trikoupis παρακράτησις withholding bill	36.4%	37.5%

Table 7: Coast vs. Interior Decomposition of Currant-Targeting Defection. Coast = currant-coast Peloponnesian MPs; Interior = non-coastal Peloponnesian MPs. The first two sections show asymmetric Coast/Interior defection on currant-targeting tax legislation. The third section shows the symmetric within-Peloponnese benchmark on the παρακράτησις withholding bill, a non-targeting currant-policy vote.

Table 6 reports the within-session domain contrast for the March 5 sitting: three consecutive tax-relief votes (Rice 0.899, 0.864, 0.860) followed by a procedural motion on the same day (Rice 1.000). The same MPs in the same sitting vote almost unanimously on procedure and break discipline on consecutive currant-tax bills. The within-session structure rules out shock-of-the-day explanations — there is no chamber-wide event between the procedural and tax votes — and isolates the bill content as the operative variable. The July 11–12, 1895 cluster shows the same within-session structure: procedural anchors with Rice near 1.000 alongside taxation roll calls with Rice in the same 0.86–0.90 band as the March 5 cluster. Constituency-cost heterogeneity

made visible by agenda content is the operative pattern: the chamber holds together on procedure and breaks selectively on currant-targeting tax bills.

The triple-interaction specification reported in §6.2 yields $\beta_3(\text{Taxation}) = +0.073$ ($p = 0.006$), $\beta_3(\text{Budget}) = -0.023$, and pooled fiscal $+0.067$ — the average elevation of Coast-Peloponnesian defection on currant-targeting taxation legislation in the post-default window. The $+0.073$ is a compressed summary of the cluster evidence presented in this section: two clusters drive most of the signal, the months between them contribute null Coast-specific defection, and the regression averages across the post-default panel to produce the elevation. Figure 3 plots the domain decomposition: positive on taxation, negative on budget. The figure is a domain-level summary of a phenomenon whose substantive evidence is cluster-level. The taxation coefficient summarizes the cluster-level evidence in the preceding paragraphs and Table 7; the budget coefficient is taken up in §7.2.

§7.2 documents the post-1896 budget collapse as a complementary window onto the same structural phenomenon — different mechanism (patron-removal coordination loss), different domain (budget allocation), same underlying latent heterogeneity. §7.4 reports three convergent signatures of high patronage binding: defection is not predicted by prior preference distance (β_6 null), is geographically concentrated on Coast-exposed MPs ($R^2 = 0.452$ vs 0.078 for prior dissent), and is not predicted by prior bloc misalignment (Low Alignment interaction null). §7.5 reports the Coastal Peloponnese moderator in the covariate decomposition ($\beta_4 = +0.094$, $p = 0.054$), confirming at the moderator level what the cluster decomposition shows at the bill level: the post-default elevation in fiscal defection is concentrated on currant-coast MPs.

7.2 The Trikoupis Death: Fiscal Collapse, Budget-Concentrated (1896)

Trikoupis died in Cannes on 30 March 1896 (OS) while parliament was in recess. The last pre-death roll call is 21 March, and the first post-death roll call is 23 November. The T-bloc was in opposition under a Deligiannis government. In a post $\times$ fiscal specification, Post $\times$ Fiscal = $+0.238$ ($p = 0.008$). The Peloponnese interaction is null ($\beta_3(\text{Pelop} \times \text{Fiscal}) \approx 0$).

Date	RC ID	Domain	Fiscal?	T-Rice	D-Rice	T defectors
1896-12-03	100320_s20_r1	procedural	no	0.750	0.931	1
1896-12-04	100320_s21_r0	procedural	no	1.000	1.000	0
1896-12-04	100320_s21_r1	budget	yes	0.125	0.959	7
1896-12-07	100320_s23_r0	budget	yes	0.238	0.961	8
1896-12-11	100320_s26_r0	foreign_affairs	no	0.500	1.000	1
1896-12-12	100320_s27_r0	procedural	no	1.000	0.982	0
1896-12-13	100320_s28_r2	taxation	yes	0.667	0.940	3

1896-12-22	100320_s36_r2	infrastructure	yes	0.143	0.690	3
1896-12-22	100320_s36_r3	education	no	0.600	0.885	2
1896-12-22	100320_s36_r5	budget	yes	0.200	0.563	4

Table 8: Within-Session Domain Contrast, December 1896. Budget votes show near-total T-bloc collapse; procedural and foreign affairs votes in the same sessions maintain cohesion.

The 1896 result is the patron-death case predicted by the framework of §3.2: a complementary window onto the same structural phenomenon documented for 1893–1895. Where the post-1893 evidence shows selective surfacing of b_i heterogeneity through agenda content — Coast-specific defection on currant-targeting bills when those bills reach the floor, silent otherwise — the 1896 episode shows wholesale surfacing through patron removal: chamber-wide defection on the budget-allocation domain that Trikoupis personally coordinated, alongside stable procedural discipline. The 1894–1895 clusters and the 1896 budget collapse are two readings on the same R_t mechanism: selective bill-by-bill surfacing through position-forcing legislation in the first case, wholesale surfacing through loss of the patron's absorption capacity in the second. On December 4, one sitting contained both a procedural vote ($T\text{-Rice} = 1.000$, zero defectors) and a budget vote ($T\text{-Rice} = 0.125$, 7 defectors). Budget allocation is where coordination mattered most for an opposition bloc: line items and ministry articles required a shared position, and crude heuristics were less useful. In the absence of a coordinating patron, T-bloc members voted incoherently on budget articles, even as the D-bloc reached near-perfect discipline on the same votes ($Rice\ 0.959\text{--}1.000$). By contrast, on procedural motions and foreign affairs, MPs could oppose the government more mechanically without detailed direction. The procedural-substantive split also admits a market-structure interpretation: the death of one patron in a two-patron system removed the competitive discipline that had sustained coordination on complex legislative tasks while leaving simple oppositional behaviour intact. Under the framework, this market-structure account complements the absorption-capacity account: it specifies why R_t collapsed across the budget domain in particular, given the duopoly structure of patron coordination Trikoupis and Deligiannis had operated (see Section 8.1).

7.3 Cross-Shock Comparison

Table 9 reports eight episodes. The estimates differ in precision across rows, but the sign and domain pattern can be compared to the π -decomposition predictions for each shock type.

Shock	Date (OS)	Type	β_3 Fiscal	p	Domain pattern
1885 Jan–Feb	n/a	Confidence crisis	n/a	-	Uniform (descriptive)
1886 blockade	26 Apr 1886	External military + govt change	-0.029	.014	Fiscal tightening (rally)

1893 default	10 Dec 1893	External fiscal	+0.073 (taxation)	.006	Coast-specific defection on currant-targeting bills, two clusters
1896 Trikoupis death	30 Mar 1896	Patron removal (T)	+0.238 (chamber-wide)	.008	Chamber-wide defection on budget allocation, patron-coordinated domain
1897 war	6 Apr 1897	External military	null	.317	Uniform mild increase across domains; no Peloponnese-specific signature
1898 IFC	23 Feb 1898	Fiscal arena removed	null	.851	Position-forcing legislation removed from agenda
1901 Evangelika	8 Nov 1901	Cultural crisis	null	.160	Null (no false positive)
1905 assassination	13 Jun 1905	Patron removal (D)	-	-	Unestimable

Table 9: Cross-Shock Regression Comparison

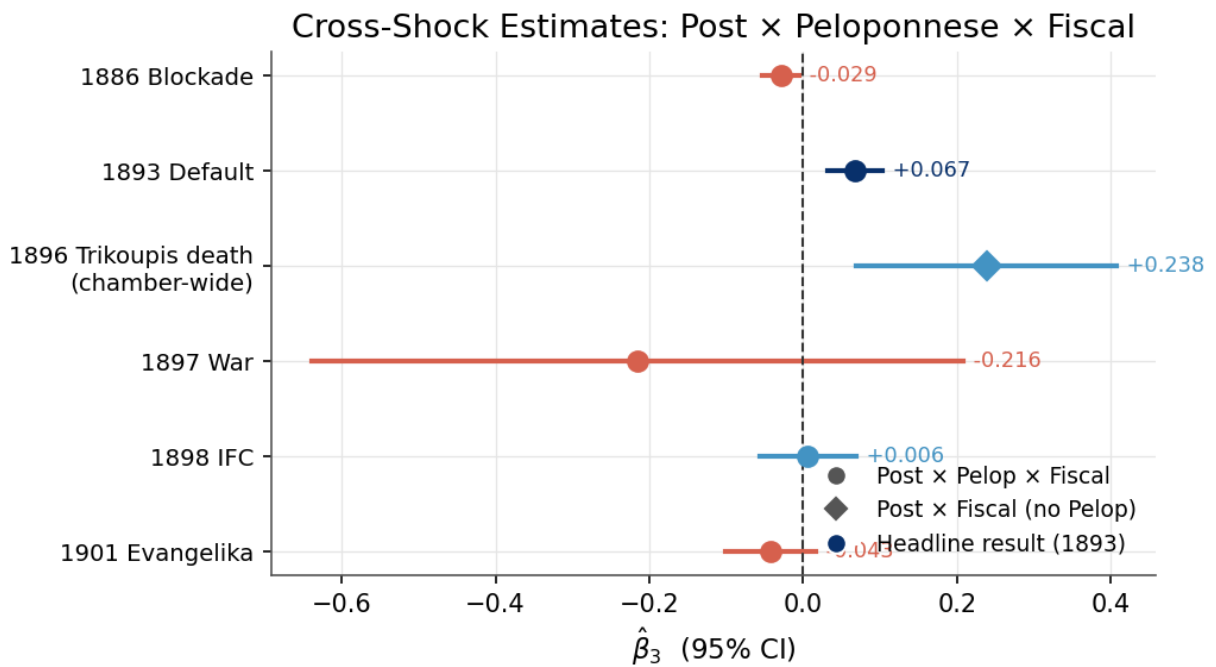


Figure 4: Post × Peloponnese × Fiscal Interaction Coefficient Across Shocks. Each point shows β_3 with 95% confidence intervals. The 1896 Trikoupis death coefficient is Post × Fiscal (chamber-wide, not Peloponnese-specific) and is plotted separately. The 1893 default is highlighted as the primary result.

Across episodes, the cross-shock coefficients generally follow the mechanism-based expectations. The fiscal interaction is significantly positive for the 1893 default, the shock whose agenda put currant-targeting legislation onto the parliamentary floor. It is

significantly negative for the 1886 blockade, which fits a rally dynamic in which external military threat tightens fiscal discipline rather than loosening it. Mueller (1970, 1973) documented rally effects for executive approval under international crises; the legislative analogue observed here—increased fiscal cohesion during the blockade—extends that logic to parliamentary voting, though Mueller’s original framework addressed presidential popularity rather than legislative behaviour. It is close to zero for the 1897 war and the 1901 Evangelika riots (episodes not primarily operating through the fiscal patronage channel). After the 1898 International Financial Commission, when a large share of revenues moved outside domestic discretion, the fiscal interaction is also close to zero.

Across episodes, confidence crises coincide with cross-domain fragmentation; fiscal shocks coincide with Coast-specific defection on currant-targeting bills; patron removal coincides with chamber-wide budget defection; the IFC coincides with a null in the fiscal interaction because position-forcing legislation no longer reaches the parliamentary floor. The 1905 assassination is not estimable given three post-period roll calls.

7.4 Patronage Binding Tests

Under the §3.2 framework, the patronage-binding hypothesis predicts that the T-bloc's b_i distribution is concentrated at high values during 1893–1894: most MPs comply through patronage exchange rather than programmatic commitment. This implies three observable signatures, each tested below. All three are Krehbiel-style identification tests, drawing on the logic that defection should not track prior preference distance under high b_i . The three tests converge.

Test 1: Domain-specificity (β_6). The triple interaction $\text{Post} \times \text{Peloponnese} \times \text{DomainDev}$ (defined in §6.1) tests whether MPs who already disagreed with their bloc on a given domain are more likely to defect on that domain post-shock. Under high b_i , β_6 should be null: defection is driven by patronage stress, not by prior policy disagreement. Under low b_i , β_6 should be positive: MPs break first on domains where their ideal point already diverged from the bloc platform. β_6 is null across all three shocks for which it is estimable: 1885 ($p = 0.54$), 1893 ($p = 0.33$), and 1905 ($p = 0.45$). This is the central preference-vs-mechanism test in the §3.2 framework, and it consistently fails to find evidence for low b_i .

Test 2: Geography vs. prior dissent. The change in fiscal defection from pre- to post-default is regressed separately on (a) Peloponnese status and (b) pre-default fiscal defection rate. Geography explains substantially more variation: $R^2 = 0.452$ versus 0.078 (Figure 5). For MPs who later defect on taxation after the default, the pre-default fiscal defection rate is zero. This is a direct preference-distance counterfactual: under low b_i , prior fiscal dissent should predict post-default fiscal defection. It does not. Peloponnesian MPs increased their fiscal defection rates by roughly +14.2 percentage

points more than non-Peloponnesian MPs, and the MPs who defected showed near-zero fiscal defection in the pre-default period — a pattern difficult to reconcile with a story in which the default simply reveals pre-existing programmatic disagreement.

What Predicts Post-Default Fiscal Defection?

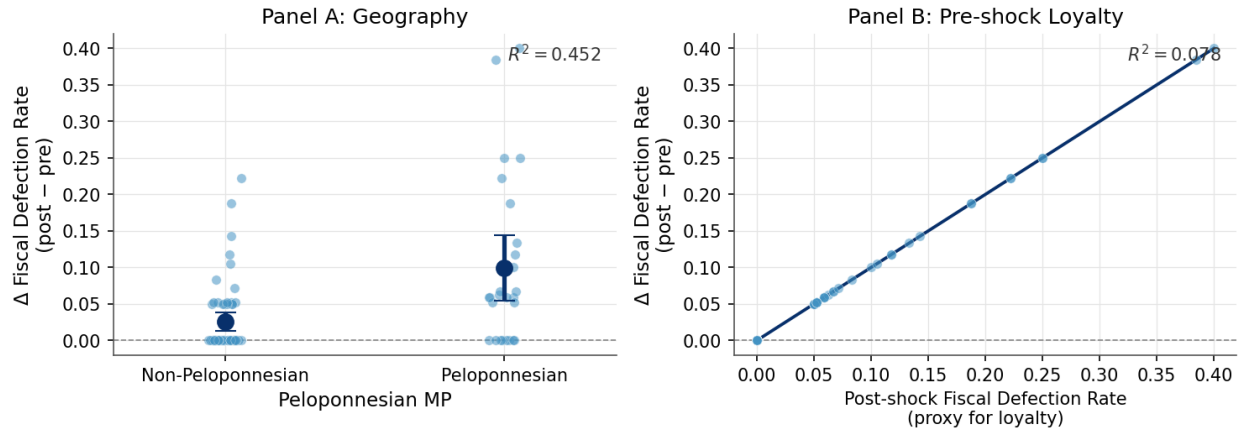


Figure 5: What Predicts Post-Default Fiscal Defection? Panel A: Change in fiscal defection rate by Peloponnesian status ($R^2 = 0.452$). Panel B: Change in fiscal defection rate by pre-shock fiscal defection rate ($R^2 = 0.078$). Each point is one T-bloc MP with at least 3 fiscal yes/no votes in both pre- and post-default periods.

Test 3: Low pre-shock alignment. Table 10 (§7.5) reports an interaction of $\text{Post} \times \text{Peloponnesian} \times \text{Taxation}$ with a Low Alignment indicator (below-median pre-shock rate_T). Under low b_i , MPs with low pre-shock alignment to the bloc should defect more on taxation post-default. The estimated interaction is $\beta_4 = -0.071$ (SE = 0.060, $p = 0.242$) — null and slightly negative. Like β_6 and Figure 5, this is informative about the b_i distribution: post-shock defection is not concentrated among MPs with prior preference distance from the bloc.

Convergence. The patronage-binding hypothesis predicts null β_6 , low R^2 on prior dissent, and null Low Alignment interaction. All three are observed. The programmatic alternative predicts positive β_6 , high R^2 on prior dissent, and positive Low Alignment interaction. None are observed. The three tests are not independent — they share data and units of analysis — but they probe different observable implications of the same underlying b_i distribution and converge on the same inference.

Cross-domain evidence (limit case). A direct estimate of the within-bloc cross-domain correlation $\rho_{T^{d1}, d2}$ would provide additional inference about π^{pattern} in the language of §3.2. The fiscal–procedural correlation within the T-bloc is $r = 0.306$ ($p = 0.001$). Procedural votes include agenda-control motions with indirect fiscal stakes, which complicates interpretation. Other domain pairs have insufficient power for direct p estimation; this is a target for future work with denser per-domain coverage.

7.5 Covariate Heterogeneity

This section reports moderator-level evidence on the Post $\times$ Peloponnese $\times$ Taxation interaction. The central finding is the Coastal Peloponnese moderator ($\beta_4 = +0.094$, $p = 0.054$), which confirms at the moderator level what §7.1's cluster decomposition documents at the bill level: the post-default elevation in fiscal defection is concentrated on currant-coast MPs, not on Peloponnesian MPs as a bloc. Other moderators serve as discriminating tests against alternative explanations (tenure, dynasty, prior alignment, distance, electoral competition) and as a placebo (Island). The moderator-level evidence is corroborative; the primary evidence for the Coast-vs-interior contrast is the cluster decomposition in §7.1. Each covariate x is added as a four-way interaction, Post $\times$ Peloponnese $\times$ Taxation $\times$ x . A placebo replaces Peloponnese with an Island indicator. In each specification, β_3 is the baseline Post $\times$ Peloponnese $\times$ Taxation coefficient and β_4 is the interaction with x .

Covariate	N where $x=1$	β_3 ($x=0$)	β_4	SE	p-value
High Tenure (above-median years since first parliamentary appearance as of November 1893)	3,730	+0.105	−0.016	0.028	0.561
Dynasty (surname and district shared with another MP)	3,774	+0.115	−0.036	0.329	0.912
High Competition (above-median co-district MPs)	5,239	+0.064	+0.065	0.039	0.098
Low Alignment (below-median pre-shock rater)	3,467	+0.129	−0.071	0.060	0.242
Distance from Athens (above-median distance_athens_km)	2,206	+0.093	+0.037	0.060	0.536
Coastal Peloponnese (currant coast vs mountain interior)	1,166	+0.069	+0.094	0.049	0.054
Island placebo (Post $\times$ Island $\times$ Taxation)	1,271	–	+0.040	0.038	0.288

Table 10: Covariate Heterogeneity

Note: Year of birth is available for fewer than 2% of observations (1,399 of 77,614). Age interactions are excluded as unidentifiable.

Table 10 reports interaction estimates. The Coastal Peloponnese moderator yields $\beta_4 = +0.094$ (SE = 0.049, $p = 0.054$) with $N = 1,166$ — the structural anchor referenced in the section opening. The other moderators serve as discriminating tests. High tenure has $\beta_4 = -0.016$ ($p = 0.561$). Dynasty has $\beta_4 = -0.036$ ($p = 0.912$). Low pre-shock alignment has $\beta_4 = -0.071$ ($p = 0.242$). This last interaction is also discussed in §7.4 as a Krehbiel-style preference-distance counterfactual. Above-median distance from Athens has $\beta_4 = +0.037$ ($p = 0.536$).

High competition has $\beta_4 = +0.065$ ($p = 0.098$). The island placebo yields $\text{Post} \times \text{Island} \times \text{Taxation} = +0.040$ ($\text{SE} = 0.038$, $p = 0.288$), confirming that the post-default elevation is specific to the Peloponnese rather than to peripheral regions in general.

Year of birth is recorded for fewer than 2% of observations in the analysis sample, so age interactions are not identifiable and are excluded. To assess joint moderation, I estimate a kitchen-sink specification that includes coastal exposure and competition simultaneously:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Defect}_{ivt} = & \alpha_i + \beta_1 \text{Post}_t + \beta_2 (\text{Post}_t \times \text{Pelop}_i) + \beta_3 (\text{Post}_t \times \text{Pelop}_i \times \text{Tax}_v) \\ & + \beta_4 (\text{Post}_t \times \text{Pelop}_i \times \text{Tax}_v \times \text{Coast}_i) \\ & + \beta_5 (\text{Post}_t \times \text{Pelop}_i \times \text{Tax}_v \times \text{Comp}_i) + \delta_d + \varepsilon_{ivt} \end{aligned}$$

In the joint model, $\beta_3 = +0.053$ ($\text{SE} = 0.025$, $p = 0.033$). The coastal interaction is $\beta_4 = +0.078$ ($\text{SE} = 0.053$, $p = 0.142$). The competition interaction is $\beta_5 = +0.038$ ($\text{SE} = 0.042$, $p = 0.371$). Coastal geography and competition are correlated in the sample.

The remaining Peloponnese effect is not limited to the curreant coast. This is consistent with the layered structure documented in §7.1: Coast-specific defection appears on curreant-targeting bills (the March 1894 and July 1895 clusters), while Peloponnese-wide defection appears on contested curreant-policy votes that do not impose location-specific costs (the February 1894 παρακράτησις vote, where Coast and Interior split symmetrically at 36.4% and 37.5% respectively). The Coastal Peloponnese moderator captures the first layer; the residual Peloponnese-level effect captures the second. Both are predicted by the structural claim — b_i heterogeneity surfacing on bills that engage constituency-cost asymmetry, plus preference heterogeneity among curreant-producing MPs surfacing on contested curreant-policy measures. Individual attributes in Table 10 (tenure, dynasty, prior alignment, distance) do not moderate the response, which is consistent with the structural reading: the relevant heterogeneity is constituency-level, not MP-level.

7.6 The Κούστας Case Study

Date	RC ID	Domain	Fiscal?	Vote	Bloc Majority	Defected?
1893-01-27	100315_s50_r0	military	no	no	no	no
1893-02-10	100315_s61_r0	military	no	yes	yes	no
1893-02-13	100315_s64_r0	municipal_governance	no	yes	yes	no
1893-11-19	100316_s15_r0	other	no	no	yes	yes
1893-11-26	100316_s21_r0	election_validation	no	no	yes	yes

1894-02-22	100316_s62_r0	taxation	yes	yes	yes	no
1894-03-03	100316_s70_r0	taxation	yes	yes	no	yes*
1894-03-05	100316_s72_r7	taxation	yes	yes	no	yes*
1894-03-05	100316_s72_r9	taxation	yes	yes	no	yes*
1894-03-05	100316_s72_r11	taxation	yes	yes	no	yes*
1894-03-05	100316_s72_r12	procedural	no	no	no	no
1894-03-06	100316_s73_r0	procedural	no	no	no	no
1894-03-10	100316_s77_r0	budget	yes	yes	yes	no

Table 11: Κούστας Γεώργιος (Κορινθίας) (vote-by-vote record), January 1893 to June 1894. Rows marked with an asterisk (*) are taxation defections. Only roll calls where the MP cast a yes or no vote are shown.

The four consecutive taxation defections on March 3–5, 1894 are bracketed by loyal votes on procedural and budget roll calls in the same sessions. On March 5, for instance, Κούστας voted with the T-bloc on a procedural motion (100316_s72_r12) while voting against it on a taxation article minutes earlier (100316_s72_r11); on the next day's procedural motion (100316_s73_r0) he returned to the bloc line. By March 10 he was again loyal on a budget vote. At the individual level, this is the cluster pattern §7.1 documents at the chamber level: the same MP complies on procedural and budget votes yet defects on consecutive currant-targeting tax bills, within the same sittings. Κούστας's record is the §7.1 within-session contrast (Table 6) at the MP level. Only 11 Peloponnesian T-bloc MPs meet the threshold of 3 or more fiscal yes/no votes in both the pre- and post-default periods, so the aggregate +0.073 elevation reflects many currant-coast MPs defecting modestly more often on currant-targeting bills rather than a handful of dramatic switchers. Κούστας, from Κορινθίας (a currant-coast district), shows an unusually clear signature: across his fiscal votes, defection rises from 12.5% pre-default to 38.5% post-default, with the post-default defections concentrated on the March 5 Rikakis cluster (Table 11 reports the vote-by-vote record). His non-fiscal defection drops from 55% to 7% across the same window — discipline holds on procedural, military, and governance votes while the post-default elevation is concentrated on currant-targeting taxation.

7.7 Agnostic Leader Similarity: Event Study Results

Table 12 reports the event study coefficients $\beta\tau$ from the agnostic specification for the cells with sufficient per-tau observations (minimum 15 per bin). Figure 6 displays the full leader $\times$ domain grid. Several patterns emerge.

First, the pre-trend diagnostic yields several “clean” cells, but sparsity and empty bins matter for interpretation. For Deligiannis $\times$ budget, the main event-study output estimates $\tau=0 = -0.8955$ ($p < 0.001$) and $\tau=+2 = -0.6589$ ($p < 0.001$), but $\tau=-3$ and $\tau=-2$ are not estimable, so there is no formal pre-trend test for this cell. For Deligiannis $\times$ taxation, $\tau=-3 = +0.1645$ (n.s.), $\tau=-2 = +0.1480$ (n.s.), $\tau=+1 = -0.0038$ (n.s.), and $\tau=0$ is not estimable because there are zero observations in that bin. For Rallis $\times$ taxation, $\tau=-2 = +0.1583$ (n.s.), followed by $\tau=0 = +0.4919$ ($p < 0.001$). For Konstantopoulos $\times$ municipal governance, $\tau=-2 = -0.0024$ (n.s.), followed by $\tau=0 = +0.9628$ ($p < 0.001$).

Second, Theotokis fails the pre-trend test in every estimable domain in the saved event-study output; budget is too sparse in the main event-study file for a formal pre-trend assessment. This pattern is substantively interpretable rather than a random violation: Theotokis was in opposition throughout the Trikoupis government period (1886–1893), so MPs were already sorting away from his fiscal positions before the default. The agnostic similarity measure therefore picks up pre-existing sorting, which means the DiD assumption does not hold for Theotokis. His estimates should be treated as descriptive rather than causal.

Third, the sign of the $\tau=0$ coefficient differs by leader and domain, consistent with bloc-specific fiscal positioning rather than a uniform aggregate shock. Deligiannis MPs moved away from his budget positions (-0.957), while Deligiannis MPs converged on his procedural positions ($+0.599$). Konstantopoulos shows strong convergence on municipal governance ($+0.963$). These heterogeneous signs rule out a common-shock explanation.

Leader	Domain	$\tau=-2$	$\tau=0$	$\tau=+1$
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	budget	—	-0.8955^{***}	—
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	other	$+0.2982^*$	$+0.3702^{***}$	$+0.0382$
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	procedural	—	$+0.5989^{***}$	$+0.3095^{**}$
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	taxation	$+0.1480$	—	-0.0038
Konstantopoulos	municipal governance	-0.0024	$+0.9628^{***}$	—
Konstantopoulos	other	—	$+0.4745^{***}$	$+0.1908^{***}$
Rallis (D.)	taxation	$+0.1583$	$+0.4919^{***}$	—
Theotokis	election validation	$+0.9106^{***}$	—	$+0.4099^{***}$
Theotokis	municipal governance	$+0.1932^{***}$	-0.7489^{***}	-0.1735
Theotokis	other	-0.3048^{***}	-0.2990^{***}	-0.0434
Theotokis	procedural	$+0.3636^{***}$	-0.2399^{***}	-0.1809^{**}
Theotokis	taxation	-0.2537^{**}	-0.0966	$+0.0101$
Trikoupis	other	-0.3048^{***}	-0.2990^{***}	-0.0434
Trikoupis	procedural	$+0.3624^{***}$	-0.2228^{***}	-0.2488^{***}
Trikoupis	taxation	-0.1436	-0.1389^{***}	-0.0870^{**}

Table 12: Event Study Coefficients — Agnostic Leader Similarity, 1893 Default

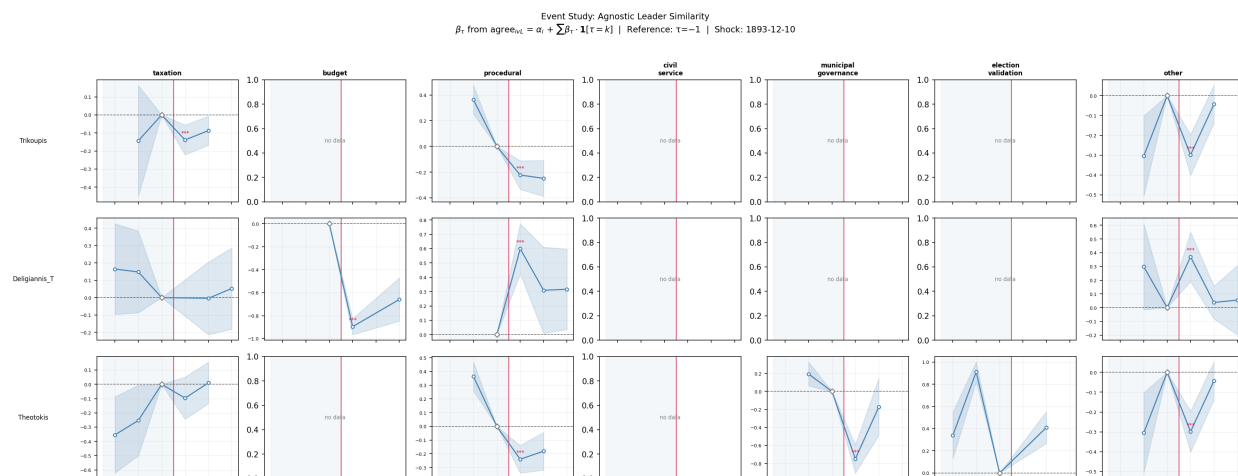


Figure 6: Event Study Grid — Agnostic Leader Similarity, 1893 Default. Vertical axis: leader-agreement rate; horizontal axis: event time τ (12-month bins around 10 December 1893), with $\tau=-1$ as the omitted reference. Note: Estimates from leader-specific event studies of roll-call-level agreement with the named leader. Coefficients at $\tau=0$ indicate the change in agreement in the 12 months following 10 December 1893 relative to the $\tau=-1$ reference bin. Cells marked — are not estimable due to empty bins. See Section 7.7 for detail and Appendix D.2 for the corresponding pre-trend classification.

8. Discussion

8.1 Permeable Patronage, Not Programmatic Transition

The evidence does not support a clientelist-to-programmatic transition in response to fiscal crisis. Patronage remains the dominant compliance mechanism, but it fails in specific ways under stress. In 1885, the confidence crisis coincides with cross-domain fragmentation. The 1893 default, by contrast, is associated with Coast-specific defection on currant-targeting legislation when such legislation reaches the floor (the March 1894 and July 1895 clusters), alongside continued discipline on most other fiscal business. After Trikoupis's death in 1896, chamber-wide budget defection rises on the patron-coordinated domain, and when the International Financial Commission takes control in 1898 the position-forcing legislative channel through which constituency-cost heterogeneity could surface is closed. The 1897 war and the 1901 Evangelika riots produced no comparable signature, consistent with the framework's prediction (§3.3) that crises without agenda-mediated position-forcing should produce nulls. The IFC episode also bears on the fiscal-political capacity complementarity thesis (Besley and Persson 2009, 2011). In the present roll-call evidence, the fiscal-defection margin closes after 1898 (§7.3, Table 9: post-IFC fiscal interaction null), consistent with revenue

collection moving outside domestic discretion; coalition dynamics in the chamber, however, do not show a corresponding shift, and patronage remains the binding mechanism. Tunçer's (2015) institutional history reports that the IFC raised revenue collection efficiency through external enforcement; the contribution of the present analysis is to show that this fiscal-capacity gain did not translate into a change in legislative compliance mechanism. His comparative work documents the institutional design of international financial commissions across Egypt, the Ottoman Empire, Greece, and Serbia. In a subsequent analysis, Tunçer (2016) argues that the willingness of debtor states to cooperate with external fiscal control “was constrained by the political representation of taxpayers,” and contrasts Greece—where current-producing constituencies could use parliamentary representation to resist structural fiscal reform even under oversight—with Egypt, where the absence of such representation enabled deeper structural changes. This asymmetry is consistent with the present paper's finding: the IFC extracted debt payments but did not reform the patronage apparatus that sustained clientelist compliance in the Vouli.

The resource argument also performs poorly as an account of short-run legislative adjustment. In these data, resource shocks do not translate into a shift toward ideological voting. Defection appeared selectively when current-targeting legislation reached the floor and was silent on most other fiscal business; the agenda-mediated surfacing of constituency-cost heterogeneity did not restructure the underlying patronage equilibrium. Defectors did not exit their patronage networks, no programmatic alternative emerged to absorb them, and the structural Peloponnese-vs-rest fiscal compliance gap that predated 1893 (§6.1) persisted across the post-default period. This runs against classical realignment theory (Burnham 1970; Mayhew 2002), which predicts that crisis-induced shifts in political behaviour should be durable and should restructure the party system. More generally, much of the clientelism literature offers limited guidance about what should happen inside the legislature after discrete shocks; the evidence here uses domain variation and multiple episodes to make that comparison explicit. The aggregate bloc-switching rate (§2.4) — 24.3% of MPs switching at least once across 1875–1905, with switching clustered around government transitions and shock years 1887 and 1899 rather than 1893 specifically — is consistent with the absence of a discontinuity at 1893, though a sharp pre/post-1893 switching analysis is not run here. The cluster pattern is not strategic accommodation by individual MPs minimising patronage costs while paying constituency dues; it is constituency-cost heterogeneity surfacing on bills that engage it, a structural feature of the legislative agenda rather than a behavioural choice MPs made and then unmade.

The 1896 result also admits an interpretation grounded in market structure, not only coordination loss. The Trikoupi–Deligiannis duopoly functioned as a competitive patronage market: MPs could credibly threaten to switch factions if their patron failed to

deliver, which disciplined both patrons (Medina and Stokes 2007). Trikoupi's death collapsed that market from duopoly to monopoly. Budget votes required detailed position-taking on line items and ministry articles, which made coordination valuable and costly. Procedural votes, by contrast, often allowed mechanical opposition to the government. After Trikoupi's death, the coordination-intensive task collapsed while simpler oppositional behaviour did not. The Deligiannis faction's simultaneous tightening on budget votes is consistent with the same logic: as the remaining patron, Deligiannis faced less competitive pressure, and his MPs had a weaker outside option. The reduced-form results motivate this interpretation but do not estimate it. The 1896 estimates are consistent with the duopoly-to-monopoly reading and with several other readings (coordination loss without market-structure logic, opposition incoherence under any patron-removal shock, sample-period idiosyncrasies); the section does not provide a test that discriminates among them.

The resilience of the clientelist equilibrium under external fiscal control is not unique to the 1890s. When the Troika imposed conditionality on Greece after 2010, in a way that is structurally analogous to the IFC's revenue sequestration in 1898, the parliamentary response showed a similar concentration of dissent on fiscal legislation. MPs in PASOK and New Democracy rebelled on memorandum votes while maintaining discipline on much other business, and the executive relied heavily on extraordinary procedures that narrowed parliament's role to ratification (Sigalas 2018; Gemenis and Nezi 2015). The key divergence is what happened to defectors. In 1893, defectors did not exit their patronage networks. Coast-specific defection appeared on currant-targeting bills when those bills reached the agenda and was silent otherwise; no programmatic alternative emerged to absorb the defectors as a structured political force. In 2010–2012, defectors often exited their parties permanently; SYRIZA provided an anti-austerity destination, ANEL a nationalist one, and DIMAR a social-democratic one (Afonso, Zartaloudis, and Papadopoulos 2015). The 2010 parallel is drawn through the secondary literature cited above; this paper's roll-call data ends in 1905 and the comparison is offered as historical context rather than as an analytical extension of the framework. Even so, much of the post-crisis literature treats this as a reconfiguration of clientelist networks under new labels rather than a clean programmatic transition. SYRIZA in office (2015–2019) reproduced key features of presidentialised, patronage-adjacent governance, and reforms in public administration remained difficult despite external conditionality (Katsikas 2022; Trantidis 2016). In that sense, the 1898 IFC episode and the 2010 Troika episode can be read as two applications of external fiscal control to the same political system, separated by more than a century, producing broadly similar outcomes: clientelist resilience with dissent concentrated on salient fiscal measures.

The persistence of the clientelist equilibrium despite severe fiscal pressure can be understood through the lens of institutional complementarity. Blankart (2011) shows that

Swiss fiscal discipline is sustained by a self-reinforcing configuration of institutions — direct democracy, tax competition, and the no-bailout principle — each of which raises the returns to the others. The Greek case represents the inverse equilibrium. Approval voting for illiterate voters sustained patron-mediated mobilisation; the absence of a professional civil service made discretionary public employment the currency of patronage; the lack of emergency fiscal mechanisms forced all distributional conflict through parliament, where patron networks controlled outcomes; and universal suffrage without bureaucratic insulation meant that the state apparatus was captured before it could be professionalised (Shefter 1994). Each institution raised the marginal return of the others. Bardhan and Mookherjee (2017) formalise this intuition: when the informal sector is sufficiently large, the programmatic equilibrium becomes locally unstable and multiple clientelistic equilibria emerge as the only stable fixed points. The equilibria exhibit hysteresis — a fiscal shock that does not cross the institutional tipping point produces selective defection on agenda-specific bills without restructuring the underlying equilibrium. The patronage system absorbs the shock because absorption capacity remains intact across most legislative business; constituency-cost heterogeneity surfaces only on bills that force position-taking moments, and only for as long as such bills remain on the agenda. After 1893, this is precisely the pattern observed: cluster-specific defection on current-targeting legislation, silence on non-targeting fiscal business, and no durable realignment despite a major fiscal crisis. The 1898 IFC ends the agenda-triggering channel by removing constituency-targeting fiscal legislation from parliamentary jurisdiction (§3.3, §7.3); the hysteresis equilibrium is preserved not because patronage recovers but because the legislative occasions that would test it no longer reach the floor. This hysteresis property is a specific instance of the increasing-returns dynamics Pierson (2000) identifies in path-dependent institutional equilibria: once a clientelist configuration is established, the costs of switching to an alternative institutional arrangement rise over time, making marginal shocks insufficient to dislodge the equilibrium. Helmke and Levitsky (2004) similarly argue that informal institutions should not be treated as residual or transitional but as durable institutional configurations with their own enforcement mechanisms and equilibrium properties.

The Greek evidence supports this framing: patronage functioned not as a deviation from institutional order but as the institutional order itself. Wantchekon (2003) provides experimental evidence from Benin that clientelist electoral platforms outperform programmatic alternatives across a range of tested conditions, particularly for incumbents and regionally embedded candidates. Keefer and Vlaicu (2008) formalise the underlying mechanism: where party organisations are weak, programmatic promises lack credibility, pushing voters toward verifiable private transfers and sustaining the clientelist equilibrium even when fiscal resources tighten. North, Wallis, and Weingast (2009) argue more broadly that the transition from limited-access orders (where rents are distributed through personal relationships) to open-access orders

(impersonal institutions) requires simultaneous disruption of multiple institutional pillars: rule of law for elites, creation of organisations independent of specific individuals, and consolidated political control of the military. A fiscal crisis that leaves the electoral, administrative, and coercive institutions intact is not a critical juncture in this framework — it is a perturbation within the existing equilibrium (Capoccia and Kelemen 2007). The 1893 default disrupted one pillar (fiscal capacity); the historiography on the Goudi coup and Venizelos's reforms describes those as disrupting all three pillars simultaneously, though that period falls outside the 1875–1905 window analysed here, and the comparative claim in §9 is offered as a direction for future testing rather than a finding of the present paper.

The finding that fiscal crisis did not produce programmatic transition is consistent with a growing body of evidence that resource shocks can entrench rather than dissolve clientelism. Trantidis (2016) shows that Greek clientelism evolved into a systemic equilibrium in which party networks are co-embedded with unions and civil society, creating interdependence between patrons and clients that renders reform resistant to fiscal pressure. Katsikas (2022) finds that despite unprecedented external conditionality during the post-2010 Greek crisis — the most severe fiscal contraction in any developed postwar economy — the clientelist equilibrium in public administration proved resilient, with reforms consistently delayed or reversed. Bazhenova (2025), analysing twelve post-Communist countries during the 2008 crisis, finds that high-clientelist states preserved or raised public wage bills under fiscal stress, a pattern she attributes to loss aversion: crises make clientelist governments more likely to favour visible short-term spending precisely because voters focus on immediate benefits under conditions of stress. These findings suggest that the relationship between fiscal resources and clientelism may be non-monotone — at intermediate development levels, fiscal pressure can intensify patronage rather than erode it.

The Greek parliamentary evidence from 1893 matches this pattern: the default put currant-targeting legislation onto the parliamentary agenda for two years; defection appeared on those bills and not on others; the agenda ended when the IFC took control. No structural shift toward programmatic politics occurred, and the patronage system did not need to reconstitute itself because absorption capacity had remained intact across the bulk of legislative business throughout. Funke, Schularick, and Trebesch (2016) find that systemic financial crises produce a large increase in far-right vote share over five years, but they also show that this effect does not extend to severe non-financial macroeconomic disasters. In their coding, the 1890s Greek distress is treated as a non-financial macro-disaster rather than a systemic financial crisis, placing it in the category where their framework would not predict party-system realignment. The roll-call evidence fits this classification: the 1893 default produced cluster-specific defection on

currant-targeting legislation within an intact patronage system, not the durable electoral realignment implied by their financial-crisis mechanism.

The 1893 default was, in the terms of Kitschelt and Wang (2012), precisely the kind of window of opportunity that should raise the programmatic content of party competition. Currant revenues had collapsed, the government could not service its debt, and the fiscal status quo was visibly painful for both voters and legislators. Yet the window did not open onto programmatic realignment. It opened onto cluster-specific defection: Peloponnesian MPs defecting on currant-targeting taxation bills (the March 1894 and July 1895 clusters) and on a contested currant-policy vote (the February 1894 παρακράτησις withholding bill), with discipline largely intact on other fiscal business and no durable realignment despite the magnitude of the shock. The fiscal conditions predicted by the theory were in place, but the parliamentary response did not follow. Shefter's (1994) sequencing framework explains why: in a system where democratisation preceded bureaucratisation, the state apparatus was already captured by patronage networks. Fiscal crisis reduced the resources flowing through those networks but did not create an alternative institutional infrastructure — professional bureaucracy, programmatic party organisation, binding manifestos — through which preference-based politics could operate. The IFC of 1898 eventually built fiscal capacity through external enforcement, but it did not build political capacity: coalition dynamics did not change, and the binding mechanism remained patronage. The first credible move toward programmatic party organisation came only with the Goudi military coup of 1909 and the rise of Venizelos's Liberal Party — an institutional rupture, not a fiscal one.

8.2 The War of Attrition Revisited

Alesina and Drazen (1991) model fiscal stabilisation as a war of attrition between social groups with conflicting distributional objectives. Their framework is entirely macroeconomic: concession means accepting a disproportionate share of the tax burden (p. 1175), and the model contains no discussion of parliamentary voting, legislative cohesion, or roll-call behaviour. The term 'political cohesion' in their paper refers to the polarisation parameter α measuring burden inequality, not to legislative party unity. The legislature appears only incidentally — once as an arena for lobbying (p. 1171), once in a historical illustration of the French Chamber being deadlocked over fiscal plans (p. 1172), and once as one of three possible forms concession can take (p. 1175). Alesina and Drazen themselves note that their model lacks a precise formalisation of the political process and suggest that future work could characterise how political institutions make it more difficult for opposing groups to veto stabilisation programmes.

This paper's prediction — that during a war of attrition, legislative cohesion should decline on the specific contested bills that engage constituency-cost heterogeneity, with

discipline holding on legislative business that does not produce position-forcing moments — operationalises the Alesina–Drazen framework at the roll-call level. The post-1893 evidence concentrates on current-targeting taxation legislation in two clusters (March 1894 and July 1895), with the 1896 patron-death case providing a complementary view on the same Rt mechanism (§7.2; §3.2). Lehmann (2010), the closest empirical antecedent, analyses Weimar Reichstag roll calls within a Baron–Ferejohn and median-voter framework rather than as a test of war of attrition; Section 8.3 develops the comparison in detail.

The IFC is better understood as a structural break in the war-of-attrition game rather than an acceleration of the endogenous resolution Drazen and Grilli (1993) model. Drazen and Grilli argue that severe crises can be welfare-improving because they raise the pre-stabilisation welfare loss to the point where the distributional prize from winning the war of attrition is overwhelmed by the cost of continuing to fight. Their resolution mechanism is entirely domestic and endogenous: one weakened group concedes. The IFC operates differently — it removes the prize altogether by transferring fiscal jurisdiction outside the domestic political arena. This is closer to what Alesina and Drazen (1991, p. 1175) describe as 'the formation of a new government that is given extraordinary powers,' generalised to an international rather than domestic authority. Drazen and Grilli's contribution remains relevant: only the severity of the 1897 military defeat and fiscal collapse made Greek elites willing to accept external control where they had previously refused. But the IFC itself is an institutional innovation that the war-of-attrition model does not anticipate — it terminates the game by removing parliament's fiscal jurisdiction, not by making one domestic group concede (Drazen and Grilli 1993, pp. 600–602).

8.3 Comparison with Weimar

Lehmann (2010) provides the closest available out-of-sample comparison: 489 Reichstag roll calls between 1920 and 1933 (*Public Choice* 144(1): 83–104), classified by topic (Public Finances, Tax, Labour, Trade, Versailles, Trust, Enabling Act). Her theoretical framework is Baron–Ferejohn bargaining, Downsian competition, and the Krehbiel median-legislator model rather than Alesina–Drazen, and her topic dummies enter as controls rather than as tests of a war-of-attrition mechanism. The findings are informative for the present comparison, though the categories do not map directly.¹⁰ Her Public Finances dummy is a broad bucket covering budget, reparations, and monetary-

¹⁰ Lehmann's outcome variables are governing-coalition cohesion (the Hix–Noury–Roland Agreement Index computed across coalition parties only) and bill-winning, whereas the present analysis computes faction-level cohesion across all blocs. Both measures register topic-specific shifts in within-group alignment, so the qualitative direction of the contrast is comparable, though a fully equivalent numerical test would require recomputing her data with a uniform Agreement Index definition.

policy roll calls; it is not the constituency-targeted distributive category at issue in the Greek case. The coefficient on Public Finances for governing-coalition cohesion is positive in 1924–1929 (Lehmann 2010, Table 13), but that period falls after the Dawes Plan and is closer to relative stabilisation than to the most acute crisis phase. The sign should therefore be read cautiously. What clearly reduces coalition cohesion and bill-winning in the final period, 1930–1933, is Versailles-related bills and unemployment, both shocks external to the legislature. The safer comparative claim is that fiscal and budget-related roll calls did not mechanically undermine coalition cohesion in Weimar. That is relevant for the broader argument, but it is not a direct equivalent of the constituency-targeted mechanism documented here for Greece.

The substantive contrast lies in the compliance mechanism and the institutional setting, not in coefficient comparisons. Lehmann finds that ideological proximity to the median legislator predicts both coalition formation and bill success — the canonical Downsian result for a programmatic legislature, in which cross-domain consistency (π^{pattern} , in the terms of Section 3.2) is high. The Greek case studied here is the patronage analogue: π^{pattern} is also high and π^{binding} is also high, so fiscal stress expresses itself as topic-conditional defection within enduring patronage networks rather than as ideological realignment. Lehmann's choice of theoretical apparatus is appropriate to her case; the same apparatus would not transport to pre-Goudi Greece, where the underlying compliance mechanism is different in kind. The two papers are best read as bracketing the comparative-institutional space rather than as competing tests of the same hypothesis.

A further institutional contrast reinforces this reading. The Weimar Republic possessed two fiscal bypass mechanisms: the 1923 Enabling Act (Ermächtigungsgesetz), which delegated decree power to the Stresemann cabinet to resolve the hyperinflation crisis, and Article 48 of the Weimar Constitution, which granted the President emergency decree authority. Both allowed fiscal conflict to shift out of the legislature under extreme conditions, with the implication that the most distributive budget fights need not register in the recorded roll-call vote at all. Greece lacked any analogous mechanism throughout the period under study, so fiscal conflict was expressed in recorded parliamentary votes. The IFC of 1898 eventually performed a similar bypass function, but it was imposed externally rather than activated through domestic constitutional provisions.

9. Conclusion

Using 755 nominal roll call votes from the Greek Vouli (1875–1905), linked to an MP registry and classified by policy domain, the paper tests whether fiscal depletion induces a programmatic transition. The evidence does not support a durable ideological realignment in legislative behaviour. After the 1893 sovereign default, Peloponnesian

MPs show taxation-specific defection (+7.3 percentage points, $p = 0.006$) with no corresponding increase on non-fiscal votes, while budget-process discipline tightens. After Trikoupis's death in 1896, defection rises on budget allocation (+23.8 percentage points, $p = 0.008$) with little change on taxation votes.

The paper introduces a π -decomposition that separates cross-domain consistency (π^{pattern}) from the compliance mechanism (π^{binding} , summarising the b_i distribution across coalition members), adapting Krehbiel's identification problem to clientelist legislatures. It evaluates resource-based transition claims using within-parliament domain variation and cross-episode comparisons.

The finding that the Greek parliament remained patronage-bound throughout 1875–1905 raises the question of when the transition to programmatic politics occurred. A plausible candidate is the Goudi military coup of 1909 and the subsequent rise of Eleftherios Venizelos, whose Liberal Party introduced formal organisation, binding manifestos, and clearer ideological self-identification. Extending the roll-call panel beyond 1905 to cover the Venizelos period would test whether the compliance mechanism shifted at that point, and whether the shift was driven by institutional reform rather than fiscal resource depletion. In the terms of Lipset and Rokkan (1967), the Greek case between 1875 and 1905 represents a pre-freezing environment: the cleavages that would later structure programmatic competition—modernisation versus nationalism, fiscal centralisation versus territorial distribution—were present in parliamentary discourse and domain-specific voting, but never crystallised into stable party alignments. Lipset and Rokkan's freezing hypothesis was formulated as a descriptive regularity about Western European party systems and does not discuss cases where cleavages fail to institutionalise.

The Greek evidence suggests that the missing ingredient was not the activation of cleavages but the institutional infrastructure—professional bureaucracy and programmatic party organisation—through which cleavage-based preferences could be durably expressed. In Shefter's (1994) sequencing framework, this extension yields a concrete prediction: once professional bureaucratic institutions and programmatic party organisation begin to emerge, patronage binding should weaken and preference-based politics should become more observable in roll-call behaviour.

North, Wallis, and Weingast (2009) provide the general theoretical framework: transitions from limited-access to open-access orders require simultaneous disruption of multiple institutional logics. The 1893 default perturbed one element of the Greek equilibrium while leaving the electoral, administrative, and coercive institutions intact. Testing whether the Goudi-Venizelos episode constituted a genuine critical juncture — disrupting all three simultaneously — would distinguish between fiscal and institutional theories of clientelist displacement and connect the Greek case to the broader

comparative literature on institutional complementarity and self-reinforcing political equilibria (Blankart 2011; Bardhan and Mookherjee 2017; Mazzuca and Munck 2021).

The parallel between the 1898 IFC and the 2010 Troika suggests that the finding generalises beyond the 19th century. External fiscal control does not break the clientelist equilibrium; it bypasses parliament without reforming the institutional complementarities that sustain patronage. A systematic comparison of parliamentary voting behaviour across Greece's four sovereign defaults (1826, 1893, 1932, 2010) — using the same domain-decomposed cohesion measures applied here — would test whether this invariance holds across different party systems, franchise rules, and international regimes. Individual-level roll-call data for the post-2010 Vouli are not currently available in compiled form (Sigalas 2018), but the Hellenic Parliament Proceedings corpus may contain the raw material for such an extension.

Limitations include OCR-related domain-classification gaps in 1882–1886 (55% coverage in the 1885 window) and failed high-frequency pre-trend tests in the 1893 event study. The agnostic leader similarity specification provides an alternative pre-trend diagnostic that does not depend on bloc assignment, but sparsity and empty bins constrain what can be tested: for Deligiannis $\times$ budget, $\tau=-3$ and $\tau=-2$ are not estimable in the main event-study output, so there is no formal pre-trend test for that cell. Theotokis fails the pre-trend test in every estimable domain in the saved event-study output; budget is too sparse in the main event-study file for a formal pre-trend assessment, so his estimates should be treated as descriptive rather than causal. A further limitation is that Greek-language historiography on this period, including work published in *Μνήμων* (Mnimon) and Dertilis's monograph on the Greek state (2005), may discuss parliamentary reactions to the 1893 default in ways not reflected in the English-language scholarship reviewed here. Accordingly, the claim of novelty should be read as applying to the quantitative political economy literature rather than to Greek historiography as a whole. Several episodes have small samples (1896: 473 observations; 1897: 257 observations). The 1905 assassination is not estimable with only three post-period roll calls.

Extensions include endogenous faction detection via SVD-based approaches (specified in the voting model documentation but not implemented here) and extending the panel beyond 1905 to cover the Goudi coup and the Venizelos period. Cross-parliament comparisons using harmonised cohesion measures would separate institutional from contextual determinants of fiscal conflict.

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Appendix A: Data Pipeline

This appendix describes the construction of the analysis dataset from raw parliamentary records in six stages. At each stage I report row counts, match rates, and diagnostics.

A.1 Source Material

The raw data consist of digitised transcripts of parliamentary sittings from the *Εφημερίδα των Συζητήσεων* (the official record of parliamentary debates), held at the *Βιβλιοθήκη της Βουλής* (Greek Parliament Library) and accessed via the Hellenic Parliament's digital library (ΕΦΣΒ catalogue). The texts cover volumes 100289 through 100331, corresponding to parliamentary periods 7 through 17 (1875–1905). Each volume contains multiple sessions; each session is stored as a separate text file. The digitisation was performed via optical character recognition on scanned page images. The text is in polytonic Greek with nineteenth-century orthographic conventions, including extensive use of abbreviations for given names, polytonic accent marks, and final sigma variants.

A.2 Roll Call Extraction

A parsing script identifies nominal roll calls within each session text by detecting the formulaic voting instruction ("Οἱ παραδεχόμενοι... λέγουσι Ναί, οἱ μὴ παραδεχόμενοι λέγουσιν Ὁχι") followed by a list of MP names with vote indicators. Each entry is classified as: yes (N), no (O), formal abstention (ἀρν., short for ἡρνήθη - "refused"), or absent. The parser also extracts the session date from the Greek date string in the session header (e.g., "Τῆς 7 Μαΐου 1886"), handling ordinal suffixes, abbreviated month names (7βρίου = Σεπτεμβρίου, 8βρίου = Ὀκτωβρίου, etc.), and two variant date formats. Of 1,028 sessions, 1,026 yielded exact ISO dates; 2 sessions had unparseable dates and were excluded.

Standing (non-nominal) votes were also extracted from session texts by detecting keywords indicating voice or division votes (δι' ἀναστάσεως, ἐγκρίνεται, ἀπερρίφθη). These yield date and binary outcome (approved/rejected) but no individual MP attributions. A total of 6,124 standing vote events were recovered. Secret ballots (1,312 entries) were identified separately and confirmed to apply exclusively to internal parliamentary elections (Speaker, committee chairs), not legislative votes.

A.3 Name Deduplication

MP names appear in dozens of OCR variants across sessions: polytonic versus monotonic, abbreviated versus full given names, patronymic initials included or omitted, and OCR errors. A systematic deduplication script normalises names by stripping accents, converting final sigma, and matching on surname plus given-name prefix. A co-occurrence guard prevents merging two name strings that appear in the same roll call (since the same person cannot vote twice). Special handling was required for five political leader families (Trikoupi, Deligiannis, Koumoundouros, Theotokis, Mavromichalis) whose relatives served simultaneously. For Theodoros Deligiannis specifically, scribal convention produced two patronymic variants (B. and Π.) that co-occurred in 301 roll calls. Co-occurrence analysis confirmed these were the same person entered twice; a forced-merge step removed 236 duplicate entries, resolving by vote priority (substantive vote retained over absence).

A.4 Registry Matching

The MP registry (1,448 MPs covering periods 1–20) provides the source of truth for identity: each MP has a unique serial number, canonical name, district(s), and service periods. A 4-tier matching cascade links each roll call name string to a registry serial. Tier 1: normalised exact match (52 MPs). Tier 2: prefix expansion — the roll call abbreviation expands uniquely to one registry given name (161 MPs). Tier 3: initial plus surname with unique candidate (33 MPs). Tier 4: Levenshtein distance ≤ 2 on the full name within the same surname bucket (9 MPs). The resulting crossref (registry_rollcall_crossref_extended.tsv) maps 4,384 name strings to 1,049 unique MPs, achieving a 96.4% match rate on vote observations. The remaining 3.6% (4,782 observations) are unmatched names retained in the panel but excluded from regressions requiring MP fixed effects.

A.5 Domain Classification

Each roll call was classified by policy domain using an LLM that read the debate text surrounding the vote. The LLM assigned each vote to one of 14 categories: budget, taxation, infrastructure, land reform, military, civil service, judicial, education, foreign affairs, municipal governance, election validation, procedural, other, or unknown. The binary fiscal indicator equals 1 for budget, taxation, infrastructure, and land reform; 0 otherwise. Coverage: 683 of 755 roll calls (90.5%) received a known domain classification. The 72 unclassified roll calls cluster in volumes 100299–100305 (1882–1886) due to batch OCR quality issues in those volumes; from 1887 onward, coverage is 93–100%. All unclassified roll calls are conservatively coded as non-fiscal.

A.6 Panel Construction

The final analysis panel contains 132,246 rows — one per MP-vote observation. Each row records: roll call identifier, MP registry serial, vote (yes/no/abstain/absent), session date, volume and session identifiers, domain, fiscal classification, bloc assignment (T/D/unaffiliated from the rolling 50-vote leader-agreement window), district, region, and biographical fields from the registry (year of birth, distance from Athens, island status). Bloc assignment uses period-appropriate leaders: Trikoupis/Theotokis for the T-bloc,

Koumoundouros/Deligiannis/Mavromichalis for the D-bloc. An MP is assigned to whichever bloc they agree with more, provided agreement exceeds 55%; below 55% with both, unaffiliated. Assignment is time-varying across the rolling window. Volume 100305 (which appears in both corpus files due to overlapping coverage at the 1886 boundary) was deduplicated to prevent double-counting.

Appendix B: Event Study

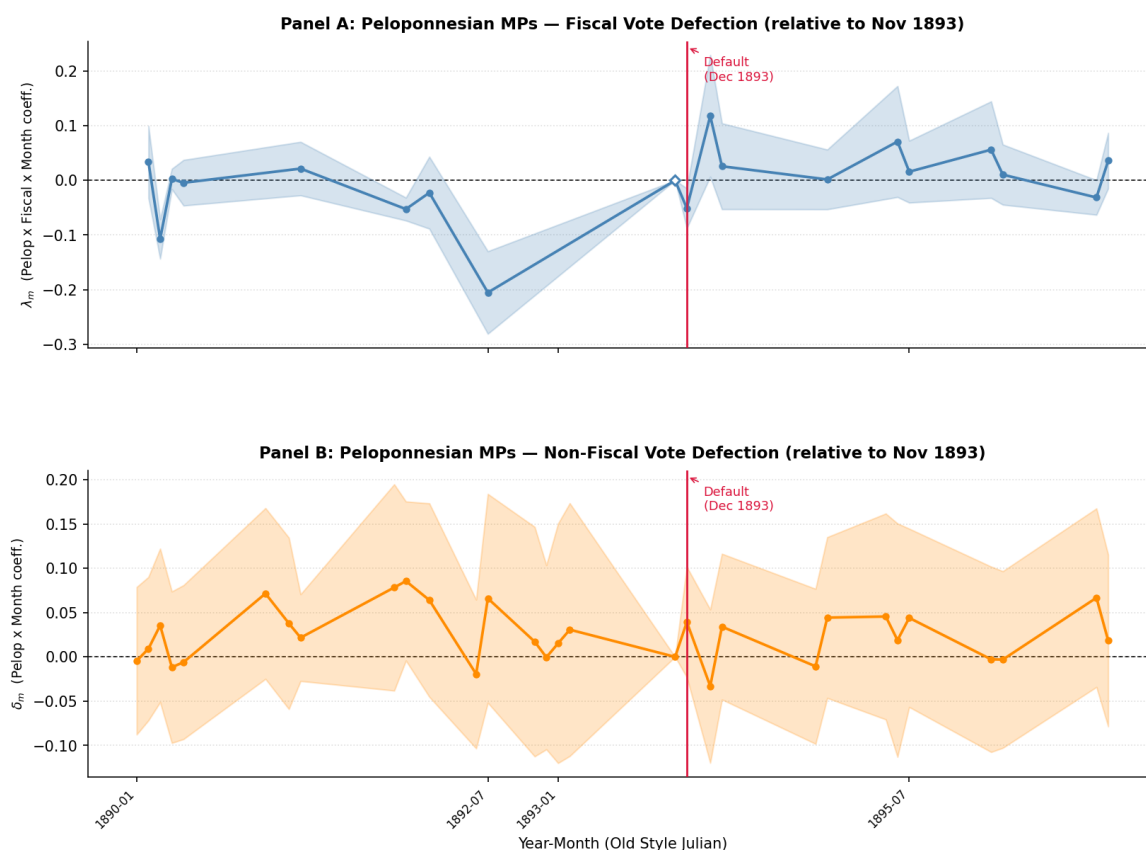
This appendix presents the monthly and quarterly event-study specifications for the 1893 default and discusses the pre-trend test results.

B.1 Monthly Event Study

The specification estimated is:

$$\text{Defect}_{i,t} = \alpha_i + \sum_m \gamma_m \text{Month}_m + \sum_m \delta_m (\text{Month}_m \times \text{Pelop}_i) + \sum_m \lambda_m (\text{Month}_m \times \text{Pelop}_i \times \text{Fiscal}_v) + \delta_d + \varepsilon_{i,t}$$

where Month_m are dummies for each calendar month from January 1890 through December 1896, with November 1893 (the last pre-default month) omitted as reference. MP fixed effects (α_i), domain fixed effects (δ_d), and standard errors clustered at the MP level.



Entity-demeaned OLS. Domain FE included. SEs clustered at registry_serial. Reference month: 1893-11. Sample: T/D bloc, yes/no votes, 1890-1896. Panel A omits months with no Peloponnesian fiscal votes.

Figure B1: Monthly event study.

Figure B1 plots the λ_m coefficients (Peloponnesian $\times$ Fiscal interaction by month) with 95% confidence intervals. Panel A shows the fiscal interaction: pre-period coefficients are individually insignificant and centred near zero, with a sharp spike beginning in

December 1893 and peaking in February 1894 ($\lambda = +0.118$, 95% CI [0.007, 0.230], $p = 0.038$). The effect fades through 1895 (average $\lambda = 0.044$) and is near zero by 1896 (average $\lambda = 0.018$). Panel B shows the δ_m coefficients (Peloponnesian $\times$ non-fiscal interaction): all individually insignificant throughout the entire window, confirming that patronage held on non-fiscal votes.

B.2 Pre-Trend Tests

The joint F-test for all pre-period $\lambda_m = 0$ rejects ($F = 9.54$, $p < 0.001$). Much of this failure is concentrated in two months: March 1890 ($\lambda = -0.107$) and July 1892 ($\lambda = -0.205$). In both months, Peloponnesian MPs displayed unusually high fiscal compliance, with zero defectors on taxation votes and 50 and 68 Peloponnesian voters, respectively. Substantively, these correspond to a unanimous taxation vote (March 1890) and a customs tariff reform (July 1892) where the T-bloc position aligned with Peloponnesian interests.

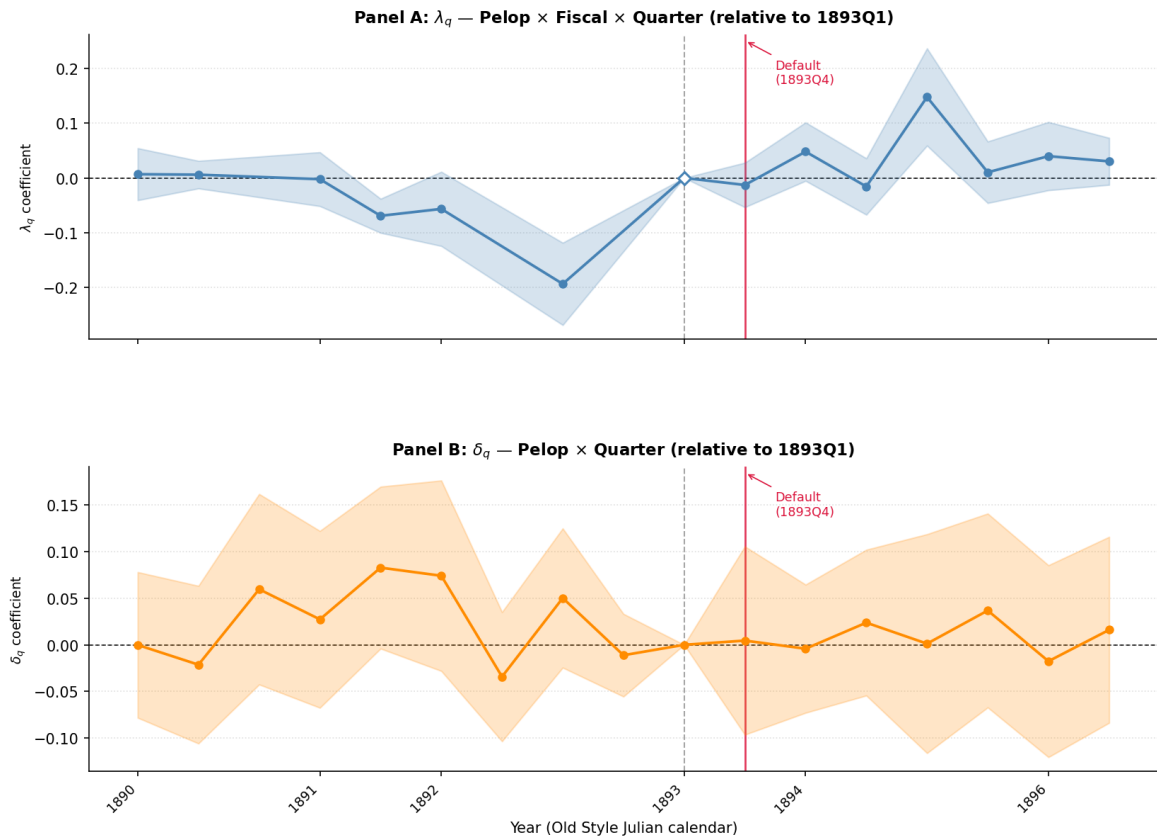
The violation is downward: before the default, Peloponnesian fiscal compliance sits above the non-Peloponnesian baseline. Interpreted mechanically, β_3 therefore understates the full swing from compliance to defection. Notably, no individual pre-period λ_m is significantly positive; the parallel-trends violation runs in the direction that reinforces the post-1893 finding rather than undermining it.

The agnostic leader similarity event study (Section 7.7) provides an alternative pre-trend diagnostic that does not depend on bloc assignment. For the cells identified as causal — Deligiannis $\times$ budget, Rallis $\times$ taxation, and Konstantopoulos $\times$ municipal governance — pre-period coefficients at $\tau = -2$ are individually insignificant and close to zero where estimable. Deligiannis $\times$ budget is an important exception: in the main event-study output, $\tau = -3$ and $\tau = -2$ are not estimable for that cell, so there is no formal pre-trend test. Theotokis fails the pre-trend test in every estimable domain in the saved event-study output; budget is too sparse in the main event-study file for a formal pre-trend assessment. The pre-trend diagnostic in the main specification (Post $\times$ Peloponnesian $\times$ Taxation) and the agnostic specification provide complementary checks: the main specification tests geographic treatment heterogeneity, while the agnostic specification tests leader-level voting alignment.

B.3 Quarterly Event Study

To address sparse monthly cells (55.6% of pre-period months have fewer than 5 Peloponnesian fiscal vote observations), I re-estimate using quarterly periods with 1893Q1 (1893Q3 contains no parliamentary sessions) as the reference quarter. The quarterly specification (Figure B2) shows the same visual pattern, but with wider confidence intervals due to fewer time-period dummies. The quarterly pre-trend F-test also rejects ($F = 6.76$, $p < 0.001$), driven by the same two quarters containing the March

1890 and July 1892 outliers. A trimmed F-test excluding those two months from the monthly specification also fails ($F = 5.63$, $p < 0.001$), confirming that the pre-trend violation is systematic (reflecting a genuine regime of Peloponnesian fiscal compliance) rather than an outlier artefact.



Entity-demeaned OLS. Domain FE included. SEs clustered at registry_serial. Reference quarter: 1893Q1 (1893Q3 absent from data). Sample: T/D bloc, yes/no votes, 1890-1896. Panel A omits quarters with no Peloponnesian fiscal votes.

Figure B2: Quarterly event study.

I interpret this as a regime shift rather than as a parallel-trends violation: the default marks the transition from a regime in which Peloponnesian MPs were unusually loyal on fiscal votes (patronage aligned with constituency interests on taxation) to one in which they defected specifically on taxation (patronage capacity collapsed and constituency interests diverged from the bloc position). The pre-post DiD specification, which requires only that the average pre-period difference is the right counterfactual, remains the preferred estimator. The event study is presented as a visual complement, not as the primary identification.

B.4 Month-Year Fixed Effects Diagnostic

A full set of roll-call fixed effects would absorb the event-time (τ) indicators, because τ is assigned at the roll-call date; the event-study coefficients would therefore not be identified. I therefore use month-year fixed effects as a feasible coarser substitute. The

diagnostic asks: do β_τ coefficients survive once average agreement levels are absorbed at the monthly level? If the effect vanishes, then roll-call-level aggregate shocks — not individual-level switching — are the primary source of variation.

Table B2 reports results from adding month-year fixed effects to the agnostic event study.

Coefficients attenuate by 40–50% once monthly aggregate trends are absorbed. Sign and significance are preserved in every $\tau=0$ cell. The Konstantopoulos $\times$ other $\tau=+1$ coefficient flips sign (from +0.191*** to −0.079*) after adding month-year FE, indicating that the $\tau=+1$ persistence in that cell is aggregate in origin and should not be given a causal interpretation.

Leader	Domain	τ	Baseline	+ month-year FE
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	budget	0	−0.9571***	−0.4824***
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	budget	+1	−0.6975***	−0.3358***
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	procedural	0	+0.5989***	+0.2657***
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	procedural	+1	+0.3095**	+0.1601**
Theotokis	budget	0	−0.3060**	−0.1973*
Konstantopoulos	other	0	+0.4745***	+0.3209***
Konstantopoulos	other	+1	+0.1908***	−0.0794*

Table B2: Month-Year Fixed-Effects Robustness

*Note: $\tau=0$ impacts retain sign and significance with month-year fixed effects added; coefficients attenuate by roughly 40–50 per cent. The Konstantopoulos $\times$ other $\tau=+1$ coefficient flips sign with MYFE, suggesting that the $\tau=+1$ persistence in that cell reflects aggregate trends rather than leader-specific realignment. Significance: * $p<0.10$, ** $p<0.05$, *** $p<0.01$.*

B.5 Succession Endogeneity Robustness

Trikoupis died in Cannes on 30 March 1896 (Old Style), which falls at approximately $\tau=+2.3$ relative to the shock date. Observations in the $\tau=+2$ bin (December 1895 – December 1896) therefore partly overlap with post-succession parliamentary dynamics. To test whether the $\tau=0$ impact coefficients are driven by succession anticipation, I re-estimate the agnostic event study dropping all $\tau=+2$ observations.

Table B3 reports results from re-estimating the agnostic event study with $\tau=+2$ observations dropped.

The $\tau=0$ impact coefficient is unchanged or slightly larger when $\tau=+2$ data are excluded, ruling out backward contamination from the succession period. The $\tau=+1$ Deligiannis $\times$ procedural coefficient weakens to insignificance (0.310** $\rightarrow$ 0.071 n.s.) once $\tau=+2$ is dropped, indicating that the persistence of procedural alignment in that cell is partly driven by post-succession dynamics rather than the shock itself.

Leader	Domain	τ	Baseline	Drop $\tau=+2$
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	procedural	0	+0.5989***	+0.6538***
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	procedural	+1	+0.3095**	+0.0708
Konstantopoulos	other	0	+0.4745***	+0.4745***
Konstantopoulos	other	+1	+0.1908***	+0.1908***

Table B3: Succession-Endogeneity Robustness

Note: Estimates restricted to observations with $\tau \neq +2$, dropping the bin that overlaps with Trikoupis's death (30 March 1896, OS) and subsequent succession. $\tau=0$ impact coefficients are unchanged or slightly larger when $\tau=+2$ is dropped, ruling out backward contamination from the succession period. The Deligiannis $\times$ procedural $\tau=+1$ coefficient weakens to insignificance, indicating that some of the $\tau=+1$ persistence is succession-driven.

Appendix C: Additional Tables

Episode	Window	Taxation	Budget	Military	Procedural	Elec. Valid.	Other	All
1885 Jan–Feb	Pre (Oct 84–Jan 17)	1.1%	-	-	-	-	-	1.1%
1885 Jan–Feb	Post (Jan 18–Feb 28)	-	-	-	-	-	-	4.0%
1893 Default	Pre (1892-01 to 1893-11)	0.0%	0.0%	3.1%	0.0%	6.7%	-	2.3%
1893 Default	Post (1893-12 to 1895-12)	7.7%	0.7%	6.3%	2.3%	7.1%	-	5.6%
1896 Trikoupis death	Pre (1895-01 to 1896-03)	18.8%	4.5%	0.0%	17.3%	7.1%	17.0%	13.8%
1896 Trikoupis death	Post (1896-04 to 1897-06)	16.7%	39.2%	N/A	7.0%	N/A	20.8%	22.4%
1897 War	Pre (1896-04 to 1897-03)	-	-	0 obs	-	-	-	8.2%
1897 War	Post (1897-04 to 1898-02)	-	-	0 obs	-	-	-	6.4%
1898 IFC	Pre (1897-03 to 1898-01)	25.9%	-	-	17.1%	-	-	20.6%
1898 IFC	Post (1898-03 to 1899-12)	6.0%	-	-	3.4%	-	-	5.7%
1901 Evangelika	Pre (1901-01 to 1901-10)	-	-	-	-	-	-	8.2%
1901 Evangelika	Post (1901-11 to 1902-12)	-	-	-	-	-	-	4.8%
1905 Assassination (D-bloc)	Pre (1904-06 to 1905-05)	14.7%	-	-	0.0%	-	-	7.4%
1905 Assassination (D-bloc)	Post (1905-06 to 1905-07)	14.3%	-	-	18.6%	-	-	12.7%

Table C1: Domain-Specific Defection Rates by Episode

Notes: cells marked “—” indicate fewer than 5 observations in that domain-window combination. The 1885 episode has 55% domain-classification coverage, so domain-specific rates should be interpreted with caution. The 1897 war produced no military-domain nominal roll calls in either the pre or post window, preventing a direct test of whether military defection spiked.

Shock	Date	β_1 Post	SE	p	β_2 Post×Pelop	SE	p	β_3 Post×Pelop×Fiscal	SE	p	N obs	N MPs
1886 Blockade	26 Apr 1886	-0.032	0.008	<0.001	+0.006	0.021	0.773	-0.029	0.012	0.014	23,169	-
1893 Default	10 Dec 1893	+0.046	0.007	<0.001	-0.017	0.019	0.383	+0.067	0.018	<0.001	20,199	420
1896 Trikoupis death	30 Mar 1896	+0.036	0.057	0.532	+0.124	0.105	0.247	+0.052	0.128	0.687	473	45
1897 War	6 Apr 1897	+0.121	0.059	0.042	n/a	n/a	n/a	-0.216	0.216	0.317	257	-

1898 IFC	23 Feb 1898	-0.13 1	0.11 0	0.24 0	+0.053	0.06 1	0.38 5	+0.006	0.03 2	0.85 1	2,22 7	-
1901 Evangelika	8 Nov 1901	-0.00 7	0.01 5	0.63 3	n/a	n/a	n/a	-0.043	0.03 0	0.16 0	1,64 3	-

Table C2: Cross-Shock Regression Summary. All specifications use MP fixed effects, domain fixed effects, and standard errors clustered at the MP level. Dependent variable is binary defection (1 if MP voted against bloc majority, 0 otherwise). Sample restricted to T/D bloc members casting yes or no votes.

Notes: 1885 is descriptive only (no regression due to 55% domain classification). 1905 is unestimable (three post-period roll calls). The 1886 specification uses a wide window (1883–1889) because no fiscal roll calls exist in 1886 itself. The 1896 specification also yields $\text{Post} \times \text{Fiscal} = +0.238$ ($SE = 0.086$, $p = 0.008$) as a chamber-wide coefficient not interacted with Peloponnese. Cells marked “—” indicate the interaction was not included, the statistic was not recorded, or the entry is not applicable.

Specification	$\beta 2$ Post $\times$ Pelop	SE	p	$\beta 3$ Interaction	SE	p
Fiscal (all)	-0.017	-	.383	+0.067	0.018	.000
Taxation only	-	-	-	+0.073	0.026	.006
Budget only	-	-	-	-0.023	0.013	.080

Table C3: Taxation versus Budget Decomposition Detail

Covariate	N (X=1)	$\beta 3$ base	p	$\beta 4$ interaction	SE	p
(none — baseline)	—	0.073	0.006	—	—	—
High Tenure	3,730	0.105	—	-0.016	0.028	0.561
Dynasty	3,774	0.115	—	-0.036	0.329	0.912
High Competition	5,239	0.064	0.011	+0.065	0.039	0.098
Low Alignment	3,467	0.129	—	-0.071	0.060	0.242
Distant	2,206	0.093	<0.001	+0.037	0.060	0.536
Coast Pelop	1,166	0.069	0.006	+0.094	0.049	0.054
Island (separate spec)	1,271	0.040	0.288	—	—	—
Kitchen sink ($\beta 3$ residual)	—	0.053	0.033	—	—	—
Kitchen sink: Coast_Pelop ($\beta 4$)	—	—	—	+0.078	0.053	0.142
Kitchen sink: High_Competition ($\beta 5$)	—	—	—	+0.038	0.042	0.371

Table C4: Covariate Interaction Summary (1893 Taxation Specification). Each row reports results from a separate regression adding the four-way interaction $\text{Post} \times \text{Pelop} \times \text{Taxation} \times x$ to the baseline specification. The island placebo is a separate specification replacing Pelop with Island. The kitchen sink includes Coast Pelop and High Competition simultaneously.

Notes: age excluded: year of birth is available for fewer than 2% of observations. The island specification replaces

Pelop with Island in the main regression; β_3 for that row reports $Post \times Island \times Taxation$. Cells marked “—” indicate the p-value was not separately reported or the entry is not applicable to that row.

Year	Standing votes	Nominal RCs	Ratio (standing:nominal)	Rejection rate	T-bloc Rice
1875	351	17	20.6	—	0.52
1876	152	18	8.4	—	0.56
1877	577	24	24.0	—	0.53
1878	232	11	21.1	—	0.74
1879	51	9	5.7	—	0.66
1880	198	28	7.1	—	0.69
1881	19	8	2.4	—	0.55
1882	192	27	7.1	0.22	0.95
1883	125	41	3.0	0.18	0.96
1884	124	45	2.8	0.30	0.92
1885	241	68	3.5	0.28	0.82
1886	45	22	2.0	0.38	0.87
1887	112	39	2.9	0.30	0.95
1888	27	22	1.2	0.22	0.91
1889	84	37	2.3	0.49	0.94
1890	106	39	2.7	0.41	0.86
1891	153	25	6.1	0.38	0.95
1892	159	15	10.6	0.17	0.99
1893	123	17	7.2	0.21	0.92
1894	100	35	2.9	0.07	0.86
1895	385	29	13.3	0.20	0.81
1896	346	42	8.2	0.18	0.60
1897	108	5	21.6	0.12	0.51
1898	90	2	45.0	0.04	0.76
1899	358	21	17.0	0.25	0.87
1900	411	25	16.4	0.15	0.90
1901	135	3	45.0	0.09	0.74
1902	56	12	4.7	0.02	0.93
1903	434	21	20.7	0.15	0.59
1904	320	32	10.0	0.12	0.90
1905	310	15	20.7	0.22	0.60

Table C5: Standing Votes and Nominal Roll Calls by Year. Standing votes are non-nominal parliamentary decisions extracted from session texts with binary outcomes (approved/rejected) but no individual MP attribution. The rejection rate is the proportion of standing votes with outcome "rejected" among those with a recorded outcome. The T-bloc Rice index is the yearly average of $|yes-no|/(yes+no)$ among T-bloc members on nominal roll calls.

Notes: The nominal-roll-call column sums to 754; the paper-wide total of 755 includes one additional roll call from a session whose date could not be parsed from the OCR (see Appendix A.2) and which therefore cannot be placed in any calendar year here. Rejection rates for 1875–1881 are not reported because the standing-vote parser could not reliably distinguish approved from rejected outcomes in the earliest volumes. The ratio of standing to nominal votes

declines during periods of intense legislative conflict (1885–1888) and rises during periods dominated by routine business or external fiscal control (1898–1901). Pearson correlation between T-bloc Rice and standing-vote rejection rate: $r = +0.035$, $p = 0.85$. There is no significant relationship, likely because standing votes capture a mix of government and opposition business unrelated to bloc discipline on contested nominal votes.

Appendix D: Agnostic Leader Similarity — Full Results

D.1 Leaders Without Pre-Shock Reference Data

For leaders with an empty $\tau=-1$ reference bin, the event-study specification is mechanically unavailable. This applies to Mavromichalis (serial 783), Zaimis (334), and Sotiropoulos (1281), each of whom has zero roll-call observations in the $\tau=-1$ reference bin (December 1892 – December 1893). I therefore report a simple Post fallback only where it is estimable. The fallback remains partial: Zaimis is *insufficient data (Spec 1)* throughout the saved fallback file and therefore has no estimated fallback coefficient.

Leader	Domain	Post	SE	p	N
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	civil service	-0.1215	0.1893	0.5226	142
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	municipal governance	+0.6397***	0.0839	0.0000	160
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	election validation	-0.2936***	0.1117	0.0088	551
Mavromichalis	civil service	-0.3430	0.2514	0.1780	77
Mavromichalis	election validation	-0.1342*	0.0775	0.0842	396
Konstantopoulos	taxation	-0.0252	0.0849	0.7665	625
Konstantopoulos	military	+0.5794***	0.0692	0.0000	308
Konstantopoulos	civil service	+0.0356	0.0866	0.6816	257
Sotiropoulos	taxation	+0.4070***	0.0802	0.0000	593
Sotiropoulos	election validation	+0.0068	0.0526	0.8967	781

Table D1: Spec 1 Fallback — Leaders Without $\tau=-1$ Reference Data

*Note: Post-1893 difference from baseline agreement among cells with sufficient data but empty $\tau=-1$ reference bins. Significance: * $p<0.10$, ** $p<0.05$, *** $p<0.01$. 50 leader $\times$ domain combinations are omitted for insufficient data.*

D.2 Pre-Trend Classification Summary

Table D2 classifies all estimable leader $\times$ domain cells by whether the pre-trend test passes ($\tau=-2$ individually insignificant) or fails.

Leader	Domain	$\tau=-2$	$\tau=0$	$\tau=+1$	Pre-trend OK?
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	budget	—	-0.8955***	—	Y
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	other	+0.2982*	+0.3702***	+0.0382	N
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	procedural	—	+0.5989***	+0.3095**	Y
Deligiannis (T-bloc)	taxation	+0.1480	—	-0.0038	Y
Konstantopoulos	municipal governance	-0.0024	+0.9628***	—	Y
Konstantopoulos	other	—	+0.4745***	+0.1908***	Y
Rallis (D.)	taxation	+0.1583	+0.4919***	—	Y

Theotokis	election validation	+0.9106***	—	+0.4099***	N
Theotokis	municipal governance	+0.1932***	−0.7489***	−0.1735	N
Theotokis	other	−0.3048***	−0.2990***	−0.0434	N
Theotokis	procedural	+0.3636***	−0.2399***	−0.1809**	N
Theotokis	taxation	−0.2537**	−0.0966	+0.0101	N
Trikoupis	other	−0.3048***	−0.2990***	−0.0434	N
Trikoupis	procedural	+0.3624***	−0.2228***	−0.2488***	N
Trikoupis	taxation	−0.1436	−0.1389***	−0.0870**	Y

Table D2: Pre-Trend Classification Summary

Note: Pre-trend OK = Y when the $\tau=-2$ coefficient is individually insignificant at $p<0.10$; N otherwise. Cells marked — are not estimable due to empty pre- or impact-period bins. Leaders and domains with empty $\tau=-1$ reference bins appear in Table D1 using the Spec 1 fallback.